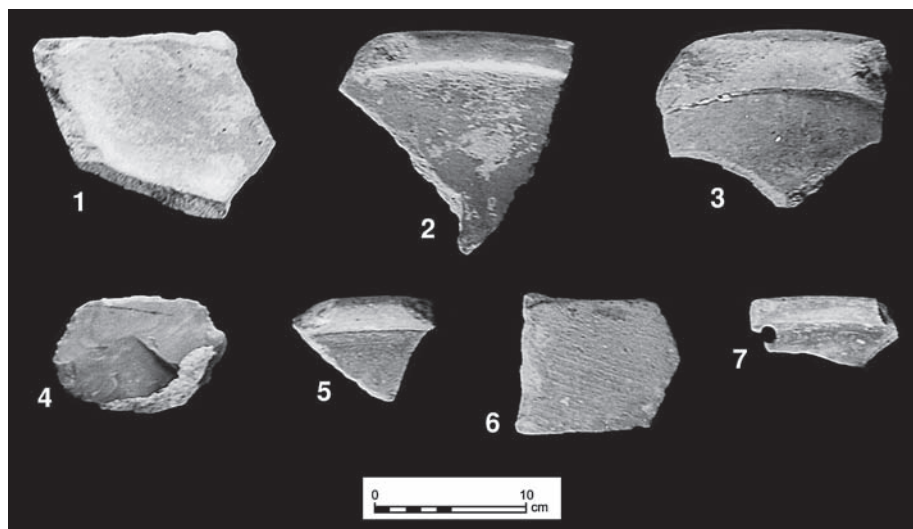




403. The moat and gateway at er-Rjjum, looking west. The piles of stone mark the place of the towers. In the background are Wadi el-Far'ah and Jebel Kebir. 1982.



404. Photos of Early Bronze Age pottery from er-Rjjum.

Site 188: 18 – 17/99/1

'Aqabet el-Kataf

Israel grid: 1896 1795

UTM grid: 7272 5659

Elevation: 120 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterra-

nean brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 2 km distantNearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 2.3
km distant

Visibility: 7

Apr. 19, 1985; 17 shards

* * *

A site on the northern slope of Jebel Kebir, about 2 km south-southwest of Bab en-Naqb.

At the site a long, rectangular structure was found, built parallel to the slope. It is two courses

high now, built of large, semi-hewn stones. Two piles of stones at the structure's edges may indicate terraces on the slope.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 189: 19 – 18/00/1

'Iraq el-Hamrah

Israel grid: 1902 1800

UTM grid: 7286 5668

Elevation: 20 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structures on hilltop

Area: 15 dunams (3.75 acres)

Topography: broad hilltop in valley
edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.7 km distantNearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1
km distant

Visibility: 5

Apr. 12, 1985; Dec. 3, 1993; 31
shards and 98 flint items

* * *

Structures scattered over a broad hilltop west of Wadi el-Far'ah and north of Wadi Khallet er-Radwan, 1 km northwest of Moshav Ham-

rah.

The 24 structures at the site are divided into three types: *tumuli*, round structures and large, square

courtyard. Most of the round structures are concentrated on the southern hilltop (four structures) and on the northern side (11 structures). The structures are 10-25 m apart in average. The three *tumuli* are 4-5 m in diameter, whereas the round constructions are about 5 m in diameter, built of Cyclopaean boulders on the bottom, with large, stone doorposts standing on either side of the entrance. Most of the entrances face northeast. On top of the large boulders at the bottom is a layer of smaller stones up to the full height, 0.5 – 1 m. The interior of the constructions is empty, except for a long monolith to support the roof. Several structures has an inner division: nos. 13 and 21 contain

two units, and no. 11, an exception, has four adjacent units and a large courtyard with internal division. No. 16 was probably a later farm structure.

In the western slopes of the site there is a courtyard, no. 23, 25x37.5 m in size. Its wall is built of large stones, 0.8 m wide. On its northern side is another, parallel wall, with later structures next to its corners.

Pottery: Chal – 22%; MBA IIB – 8%; IrA IA – 12%; Byz (in the courtyard area and southern part) – 58%.

Flint find: Neolithic and Chal; see appendix.

No architectural parallels to this site have been found. It is a unique

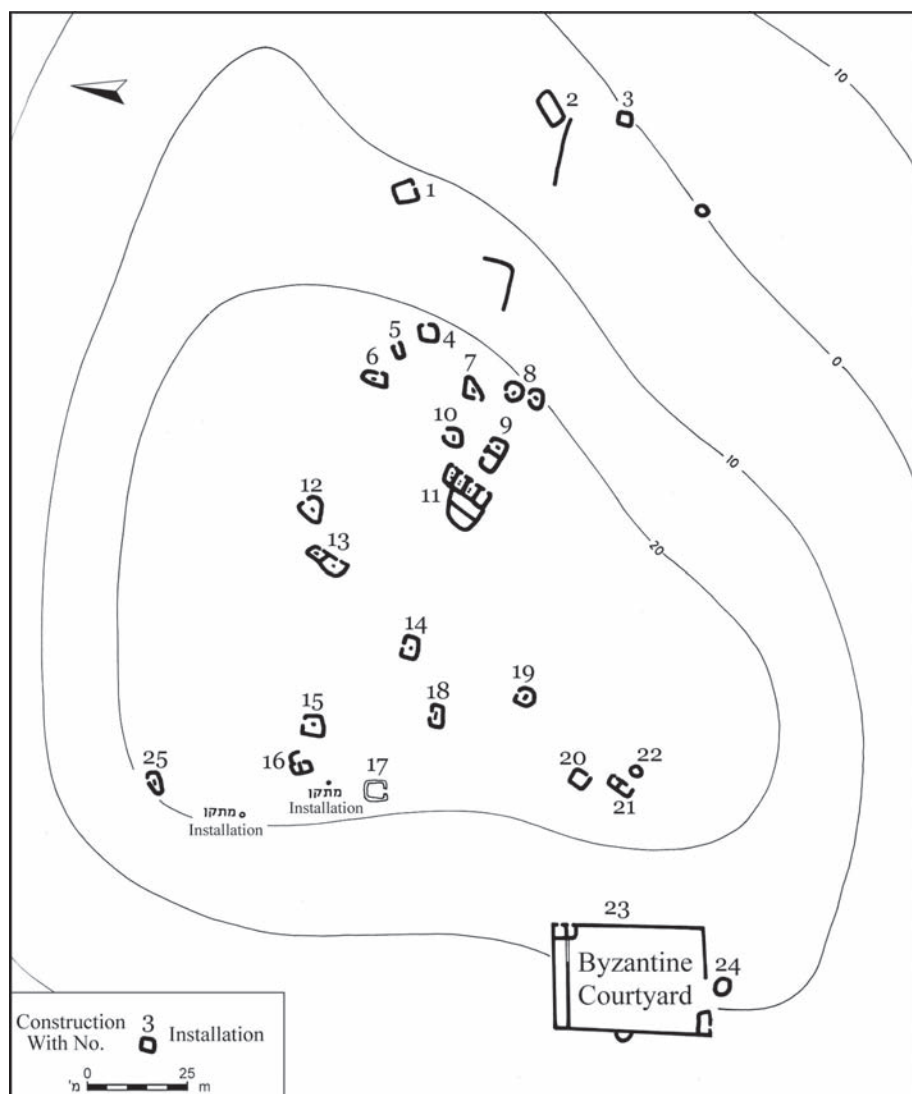


405. One of the round structures at 'Iraq el-Hamrah, viewed northward. Note the pair of standing monoliths in the entrance at right. Winter 1993.

site; it is difficult to assume that it was used as a dwelling place. Small finds are few, and the connection

between them and the structures is not clear.

Previous surveys: none.



406. Plan of the site at 'Iraq el-Hamrah, with numbered structures. No. 23 is a courtyard from the Byzantine Period. The period of the rest is unknown.



407. Aerial photo looking west of the site of 'Iraq el-Hamrah. The Byzantine Period courtyard is at top left. The fields in the upper background are on the southern step of Wadi el-Far'ah. 1994.



408. Structure no. 15 at 'Iraq el-Hamrah, looking west. In the background are the valley of Wadi el-Far'ah and the range of Jebel Kebir. Winter 1994.

Site 190: 19 – 17/29/2

Tel Abu Rumh

(SWP map: Tell Abu Rumh; Guérin: Tell es-Safra)

Israel grid: 1927 1794

UTM grid: 7319 5659

Elevation: 107 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: small site

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: hilltop and valley

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: terra rossa and brown-basal-

tic; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.3 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3),
passes by site

Visibility: 3

Feb. 28, 1983; 62 shards

A small site on an isolated hilltop, in the central part of the valley of Wadi el-Far'ah and north of the river. North of it is the road to Beqa'ot and Meholah.

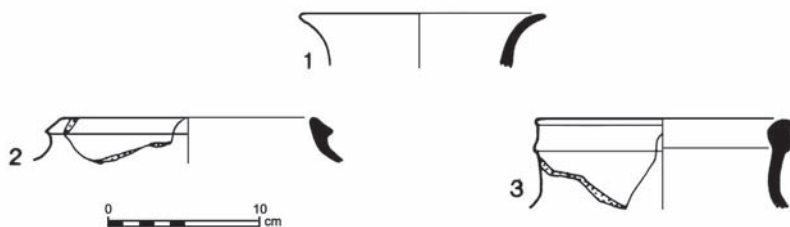
The site is partly destroyed due to non-archaeological excavation activities. The remnants of *tumuli* on its summit lead to a possible conclusion that there was here a Middle Bronze Age I settlement and a Middle Bronze Age IIB cemetery, after which it ceased to exist.

This may be Tel es-Safrah mentioned by Guérin as a “small hill ... its top is covered by a pile of large and medium-sized stones”. Conder and Kitchener saw it as “an artificial tell with remains of foundations”.

Pottery: MBA I – 80%; MBA IIB – 20%.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 92.

Bibliography: Guérin 1969 (IV), 253; SWP II, 246.



409. Pottery from Tel Abu Rumh: 1. Jar, yel, MBA I; 2. CP, dk, MBA II; 3. Jar, yel, MBA II.

Site 191: 19 – 17/28/1

**Mrah el-‘Enab (SWP map: El-Buseliyeh; British Mandate
1:100.000 map: Mrah el-Inab; Guérin: Kh. Aliakeloum)**

Israel grid: 1928 1789

UTM grid: 7319 5653

Elevation: 100 m b.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: fortified tell

Area: 16.8 dunams (4.2 acres)

Topography: ravine edge and ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and brown-basaltic; quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 3

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far‘ah (no. 104), 0.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far‘ah – Jiftliq (B3), passes at foot of site

Visibility: 5

Mar. 19, 1984; Nov. 26, 1993; 142 shards and six flint items

* * *

A tell at the tope of the northern cliff above Wadi el-Far‘ah, in the middle of the river valley. The road to the Jordan Valley and Wadi el-Far‘ah is at the foot of the site, to

the south. The site is conveniently approached only from the north. Now (2000) it became a Bedouin settlement.

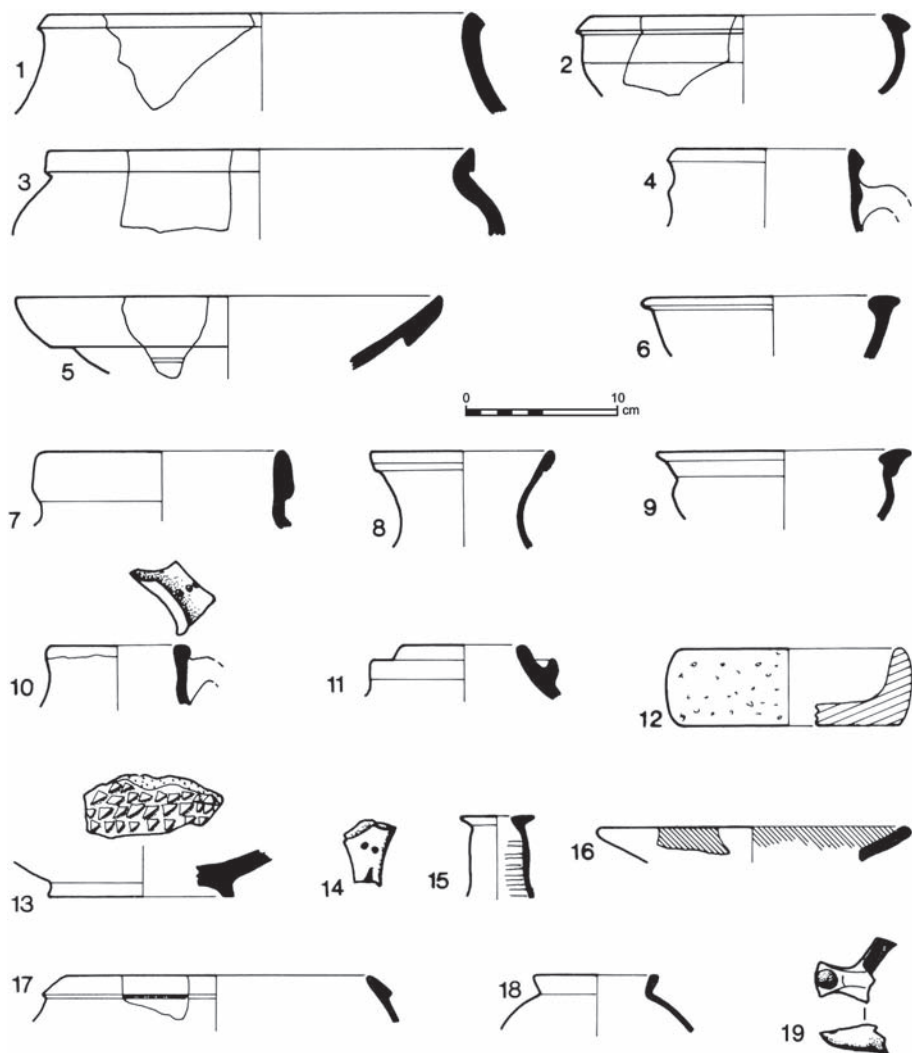
From the site a steep cliff de-



410. View of Mrah el-‘Enab from the south-west. The site is on the hill in the center, and below it is Wadi el-Far‘ah. Winter 1992.

scends southward to the road. On the upper part of the cliff, upon a rock step, the remains of a 2 m wide stone wall are discerned, built of large field stones. It surrounds the

tell on the south and the west. The southern slope is entirely built up with many remains of walls. In the upper part there is a modern house, with structural remains of large



411. Pottery from Mrah el-'Enab: 1. Crater, gray, IrA I; 2. Bowl, br/gray, IrA III; 3. CP, gray, IrA I; 4. Jug, lt br, IrA II; 5. Bowl, yel, Per; 6. Small jar, lt, MBA II; 7. Pythos, gray, IrA I; 8. Jar, lt, IrA II; 9. Bowl, lt, MBA II; 10. Jug, lt br, IrA I; 11. Jar, gray, IrA I-II; 12. Bowl, basalt; 13. Bowl base, wedge dec, gray/orange, IrA III; 14. Handle with 'Human face' dec, IrA I; 15. Small jug; lt, Hel; 16. Bowl, wh and red slip, IrA II; 17. CP, dk br, IrA IB; 18. Jar, lt, Hel; 19. Lamp, lt, ER.

stones, and a plastered pool nearby. This might have been a fortress for protecting the road during the Roman Period.

Guérin, who called the place Kh. el-Yaklum, noted the site's wall. Conder and Kitchenner quoted Guérin, calling by this name to two other ruins: Kh. Buseliyeh and el-

Farsheh.

Pottery: MBA I – 15%; IrA IA – 20%; IrA II – 30%; IrA III – 5%; Per – 5%; Hel – 5%; ER – 20%.

Flint find: IrA. See appendix

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 174.

Bibliography: Guérin 1969 (IV), 254-255; SWP II, 236.



412. Plan of Mrah el-'Enab. The entrance to the site was apparently in the center of the northeastern side. According to the plan, it could have been a military site in the Roman period.



413. View of the site at Mrah el-'Enab, looking north. In the background are Wadi el-Far'ah and Jebel Kebir.



414. Corner of lower wall at Mrah el-'Enab. Winter 1993.

Site 192: 19 – 17/38/1

el-Farsheh

Israel grid: 1931 1786

UTM grid: 7321 5653

Elevation: 123 m b.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: ravine edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and brown-basal-

tic; quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.7 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.3
km distant

Visibility: 5

Mar. 19, 1984; 39 shards

* * *

A site at the eastern edge of el-Farsheh Range, about 0.5 km southeast of Mrah el-'Enab.

On a hill the remains of a structure or two, and several walls *in situ*, built from medium-sized stones, were found. The entrance to the structures was from the west, where a square building of large stones was

also found. The shards are concentrated only around the structures.

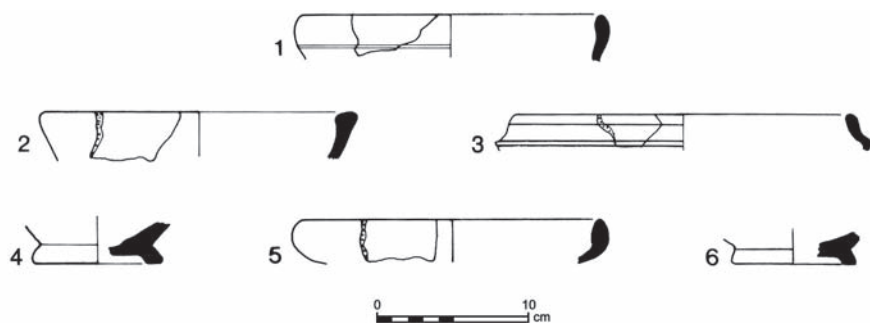
This was an isolated structure or a farm, possibly connected to the fortified site at Mrah el-'Enab.

Pottery: IrA IC – 20%; IrA II – 80%.

Previous surveys: none.



415. el-Farsheh from the west. The remains are on the hill, near the jeep. 1984.



416. Pottery from el-Farsheh: 1-2. Bowls, br, IrA IC; 3. CP, br, IrA IC; 4, 6. Jug bases, br, IrA II; 5. Bowl, br, IrA I.



Site 193: 19 – 17/27/1

Khirbet Ghadbaneh

Israel grid: 1920 1779

UTM grid: 7314 5645

Elevation: 78 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: medium-sized ruin

Area: 1.5 dunams (0.38 acre)

Topography: valley

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;
quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 1 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1
km distant

Visibility: 4

Dec. 28, 1983; Apr. 24, 1992; 22
shards

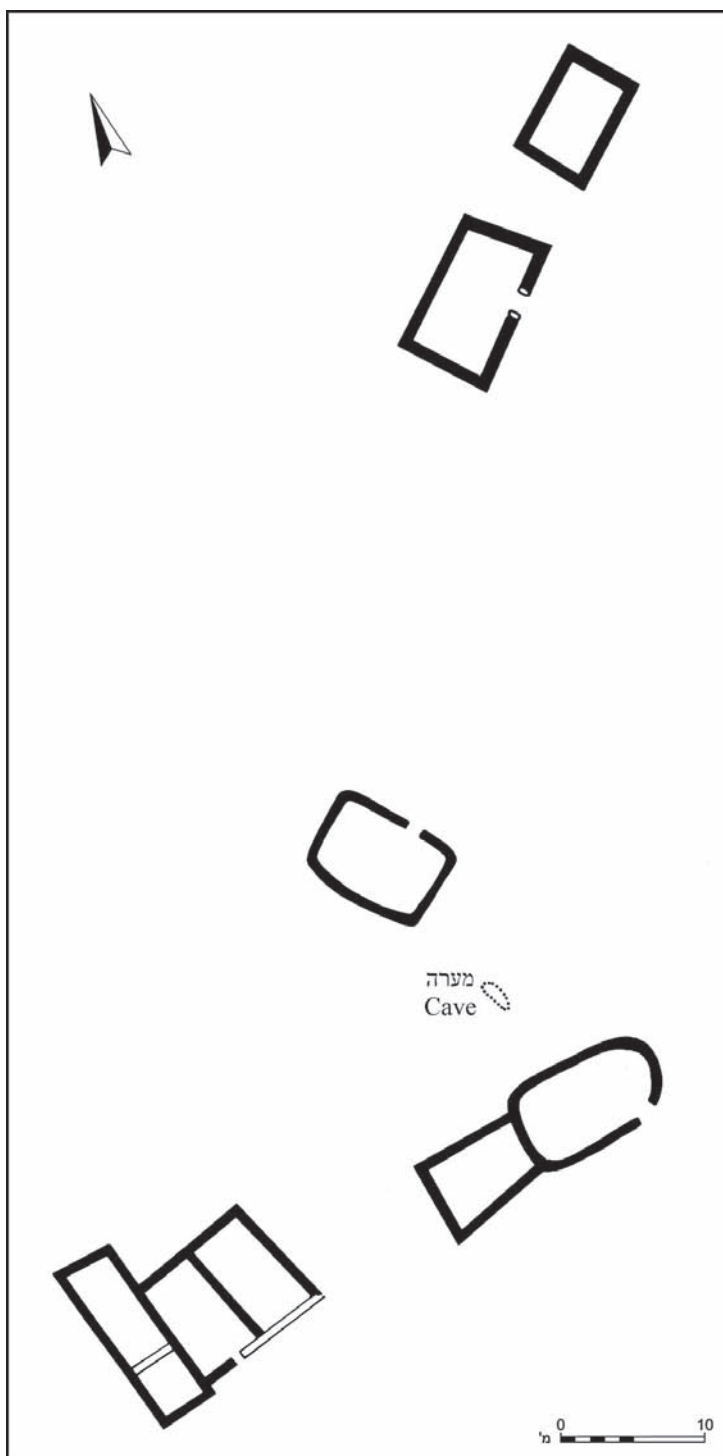
A site in the area of low hills south of Wadi el-Far'ah, about 1 km southeast of Moshav Hamrah.

The five structures on the site are built of walls 0.8 m wide of small stones. The three northern structures contain one room each, with doorposts at the entrance. To the two southern structures courtyards

are attached. The distances between the structures are 10-50 m; in the southern part of the site there are cave openings, and two cisterns were found in the houses.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 100.



417. Plan of the village from the Byzantine Period at Kh. Ghadbaneh.

Site 194: 19 – 17/37/1

Khirbet Basaliyyeh (on SWP map: Buseiliyeh)

Israel grid: 1936 1779

UTM grid: 7326 5646

Elevation: 140 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 18 dunams (4.5 acres)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 6

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.3 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3),
passes by site

Visibility: 2

Feb. 28, 1983; 78 shards

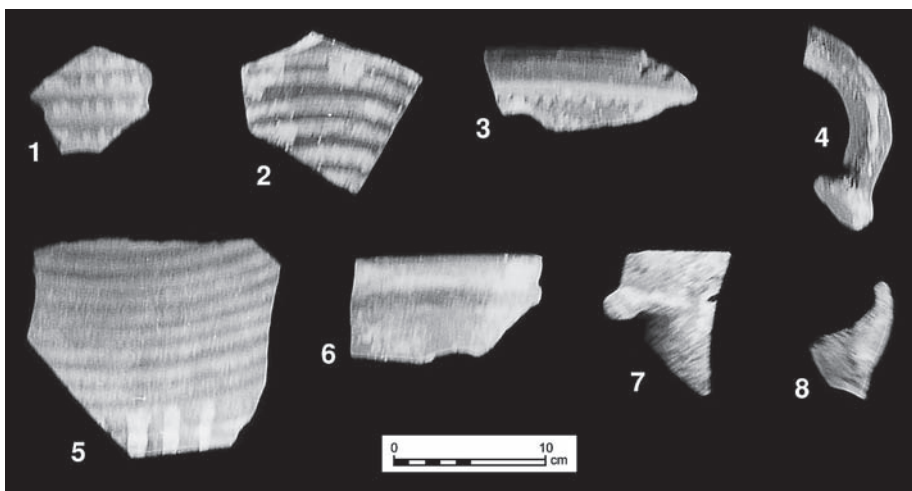
A large ruin in a broad ravine, where two wadis (Jofeh and Bai-yadheh) exit to Wadi el-Far'ah from the north. The Shechem – Jiftliq road runs north of the site.

On a flat hilltop, in the eastern part of the ravine, remains of several structures were found *in situ*, among them walls of hewn stones. According to the finds, the structures may be dated to Early Bronze

Age I. In the field west of the hill is a large scatter of shards and glass, but no building remains. North of the site there are new structures (Bedouin dwellings).

Pottery: EBA I – 10%; IrA II – 10%; ER – 10%; Byz – 50%; EM – 20%.

Coin find: 10 coins from the Late Roman, Byzantine and Medieval Periods; see appendix.



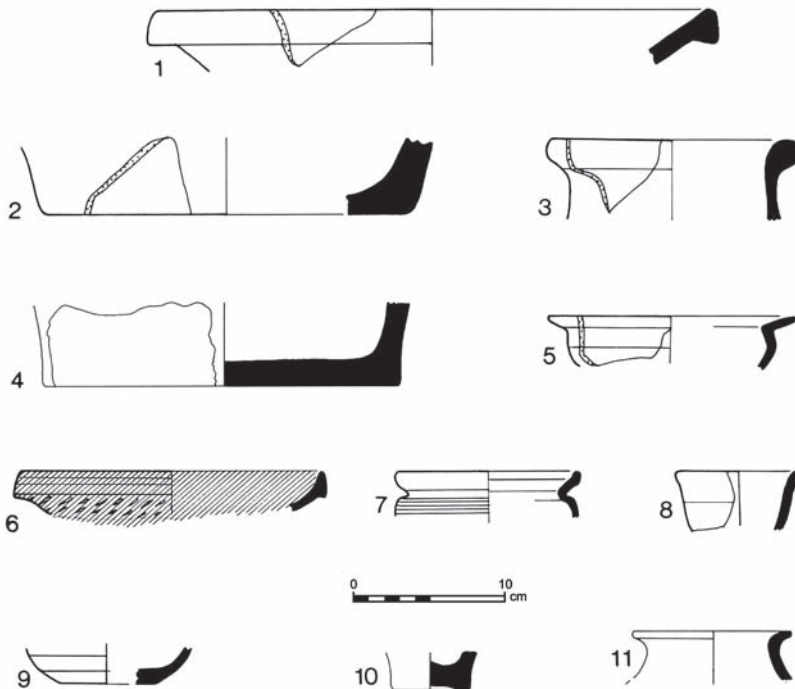
418. Photos of pottery from Kh. Basaliyyeh.

Guérin visited the site and gave it its present name. He found a built rectangle, 33x58 paces in size, with walls 0.95 m wide. The structure also contained a cellar, which, according to Guérin, the Arabs called “el-Habis” – the prison. There is no trace of this structure today. Guérin

also discussed the matter of identification; see chapter on identifications.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 176.

Bibliography: SWP II, 236; Guérin 1969 (IV), 251-253.



419. Pottery from Kh. Basaliyyeh: 1. Bowl, lt, MA; 2. Jar base, lt, EBA I-II; 3. Jar, gray, IrA II; 4. Jar base, gray, EBA I; 5. Bowl, br, LR; 6. Bowl, red slip and dec, ER; 7. Bowl, black, Byz; 8. Jar, lt br; ER; 9. Jug base, lt, MA; 10. Chalice base, yel, EBA I; 11. Jar, lt, LR.

Site 195: 19 – 17/27/2

Umm ez-Zrub

Israel grid: 1922 1771	soil; quality: 4
UTM grid: 5644 7306	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 120 m b.s.l., 25 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
Site type: farm	(no. 104), 0.8 km distant
Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)	Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.8
Topography: ridge edge	km distant
Rock type: 'Avdat formation	Visibility: 4
Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest	May 15, 1992; 8 shards

* * *

A structure with attached courtyard on a ridge edge, part of the area west of Wadi el-Far'ah and 1.5 km southeast of Moshav Hamrah.

Two walls, built of medium-sized stones, remained of the structure.

To the south is an adjacent courtyard, built of small stones, 12x12 m in size.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 196: 19 – 17/36/1

ed-Dajan

(SWP: Ed-Dejan and on new maps: Kh. ed-Dikah)

Israel grid: 1934 1762	quality: 5
UTM grid: 7326 5628	Cultivation: field crops
Elevation: 170 m b.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 1
Name type: historical site on map	Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
Site type: small ruin	(no. 104), passes by site
Area: 1.8 dunams (0.45 acre)	Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3),
Topography: valley	passes by site
Rock type: 'Avdat formation	Visibility: 3
Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;	Feb. 28, 1983; 27 shards

* * *

A site on a low, rocky hillock, on the southern bank of Wadi el-Far'ah and west of the narrow pass ("dike") where the road to the Jordan Valley

pass.

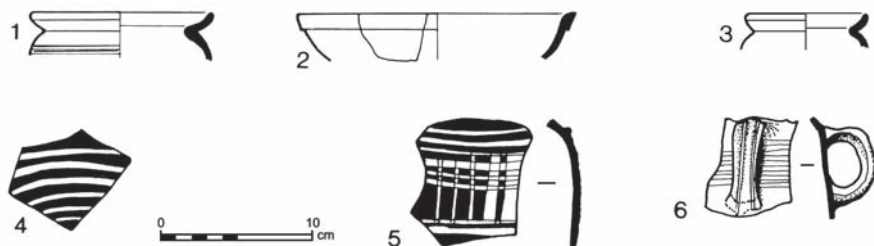
A modern house stands on the site, with few shards scattered in the fields east and south of the struc-

ture. The hillock is surrounded by fences of cleared stones. In the walls of the new structure and the fences there are ancient building-stones. The original name of the site, according to the local people, is ed-

Dika (do not appear in the Israeli Emergency Survey).

Pottery: Byz – 90%; EM – 10%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 178.



420. Pottery from ed-Dajan (all Byz): 1, 3. Bowls, lt br; 2. Bowl, br; 4-6. Jars, wh dec on bl, Byz-EM.



421. The site of ed-Dajan (on low hillock with structure) and Bab ed-Dayyq (on high hilltop, above cypresses), looking east. 1987.

Site 197: 19 – 17/35/1

Bab ed-Dayyq

Israel grid: 1936 1759

UTM grid: 7328 5626

Elevation: 170 m b.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map but not as historical site

Site type: small tell

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: ridge edge and hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 0.3 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 5

Feb. 28, 1983; 49 shards and 12 flint items

* * *

A tell on a high, prominent hilltop, above and south of the deep gorge of Wadi el-Far'ah, who pass here through its narrowest point. From this place the river delta opens to the east towards the Jordan River.

Army entrenchment, which has ruined the shape of the site, covers now the hilltop. The original, approach to the tell was from the south only; to the west, north and east there are steep slopes. Appar-



422. The site of Bab ed-Dayyq, looking west. the tel is on the highest point above the cliff.

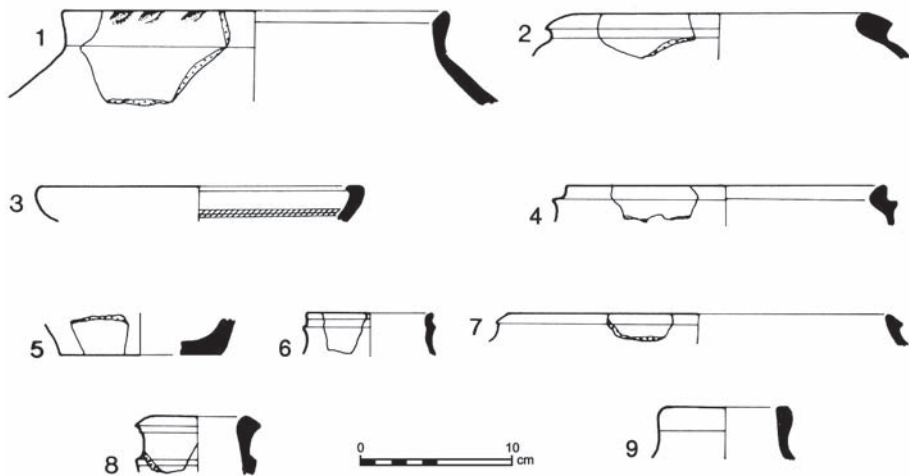
ently, above the summit there was a fortress with a small settlement around. In the 1968 survey a large structure or wall surrounding an enclosure was found. According to the surveyor, it was a foundation for a brick structure built on top of it. Today there are no structural remains, but many shards on the slopes.

The site's location supports Porath's opinion that this was possibly a lookout fortress or tower to guard the Wadi el-Far'ah road.

Pottery: EBA I – 20%; IrA IA – 20%; “Eynun” pottery – 20%; IrA II – 30%; IrA III – 10%.

Flint find: Chal; see appendix.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 110.



423. Pottery from Bab ed-Dayyq: 1. Crater, pk, EBA; 2. Crater-HM jar, gray, IrA I-II; 3. Bowl, lt, red dec, IrA II; 4. CP, dk br, IrA II; 5. Jar base, lt, EBA I-II; 6. Jug, lt br, IrA II; 7. CP, dk br, IrA IA; 8. Jar, gray, IrA II; 9. Jar, br, IrA II.

CHAPTER TWELVE

RAS HUMSAH

LANDSCAPE UNIT 20



View from the Jordan River of the mountain ranges of the Desert Fringes
etching by D. Roberts (1839)

Site 198: 19 – 18/42/2

Umm er-Rkab (C)

Israel grid: 1941 1827

UTM grid: 7323 5697

Elevation: 110 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: courtyard

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina; qual-

ity: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 5

May 1, 1992; 41 shards

* * *

A courtyard on a western slope of Umm er-Rkab Range, with a fine view of Moshav Beqa'ot and the central Buqei'ah.

The courtyard, 9x11 m in size and built of large stones, has 1 m wide walls. A considerable shard scatter

was found around and inside.

It belongs to a group of sites of this type in the Manasseh fringes, which apparently had an agricultural function.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



424. The courtyard at Umm er-Rkab (C), looking west. In the background are Moshav Beqa'ot (at left), the Buqei'ah and Ras Jadir. 1994.

Site 199: 19 – 18/42/1

Umm er-Rkab (B)

Israel grid: 1944 1823

UTM grid: 7325 5694

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 15 dunams (3.75 acres)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina; qual-

ity: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3.5 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 3

May 1, 1992; 38 shards

* * *

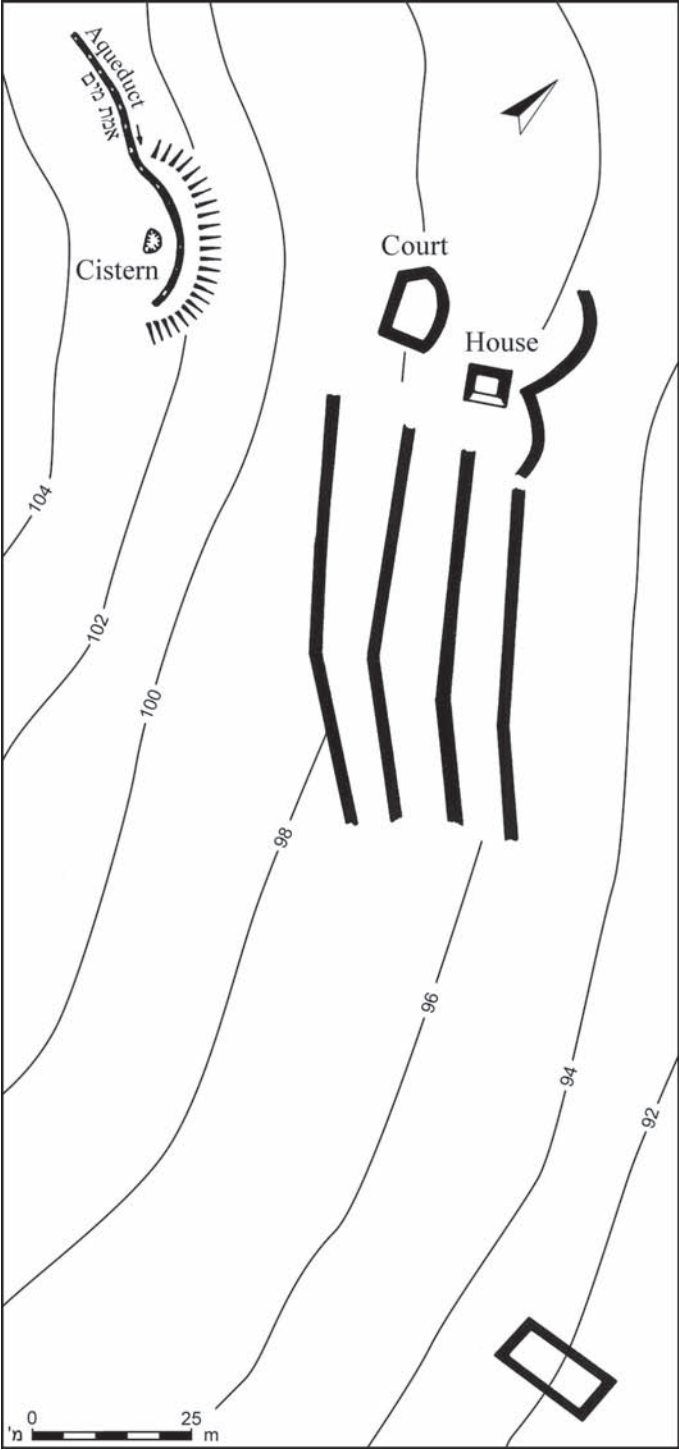
A farm-complex on the northern slope of Umm er-Rkab Range, overlooking the central Buqei'ah.

In the center there is a house 6x4 m in size, built of large stones. Its

shape has been blurred by piling of stones. West and upward slope, is a courtyard 6x12 m in size, irregular in shape, surrounded by wall of large stones. About 150 m to



425. A house on the slope at Umm er-Rkab (B), looking west. At bottom right is the ravine leading to Moshav Beqa'ot, and in background - the Buqei'ah plain. Winter 1994.



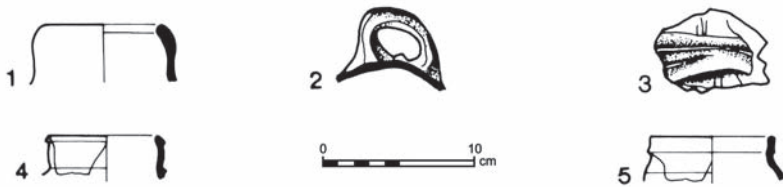
426. Plan of farm at Umm er-Rkab (B). Note terraces and cistern with water channel.

the southeast is another well built courtyard. 30 m west of the central complex, on the upward slope, there is a hewn cistern with a channel leading to it. Southwest of the

complex there are many agricultural terraces. A considerable shard scatter is around the complex.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



427. Pottery from Umm er-Rkab (B), all Byz; dk br and reddish: 1. Jar; 2-3. Jar handles; 4. Jar with ridge, ER; 5. Jug.



Site 200: 19 – 18/01/3

Umm ej-Juren

Israel grid: 1909 1814

UTM grid: 7301 5679

Elevation: 130 m a.s.l., 120 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: ridge edge and high summit

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 0.6 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 9

May 21, 1982; Jan. 29, 1993; 62

shards

A large structure on a ridge edge in the hills of Umm ej-Juren, a high range overlooking from the north the central part of of Wadi el-Far'ah. The site, viewing also the eastern Buqe'ah, is 1 km southeast of Tel Shibli

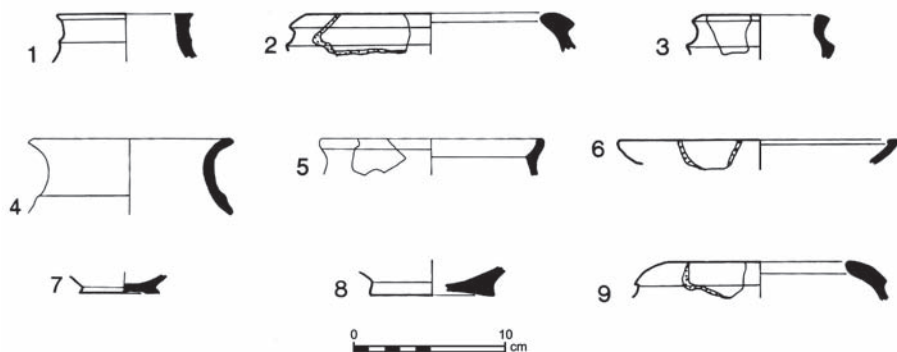
The structure, built of large stones, is trapezoidal; it is 20 m long

(northern and southern walls), 14 m (eastern wall) and 10 m (west). There is a secondary division in the eastern side, which creates a long room. A parallel wall of big boulders is found some 6 m east of the building. The rich collection of pottery indicate intensive use, and the site may have been used as an

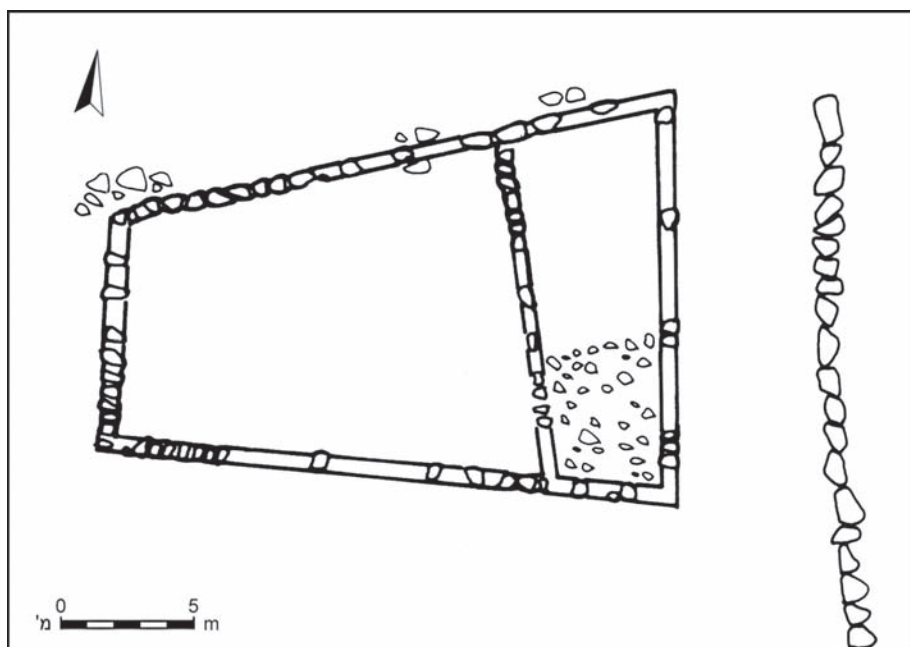
outlook fortress.

– 80%.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 20%; IrA II *Previous surveys:* none.



428. Pottery from Umm ej-Juren: 1-3, 9 - IrA II; 4-8 - MBA II: 1. Jar, br; 2. Crater, br; 3. Ridged jar, dk gray; 4. Jar, lt (MBA I); 5-6. Bowls, yel; 7-8. Bowl bases, br; 9. HM jar, dk.



429. Plan of the site at Umm ej-Juren.

Site 201: 19 – 18/11/1

Ras Bilam ez-Zef (A)

Israel grid: 1914 1815

UTM grid: 7307 5682

Elevation: 170 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: cairn

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 1 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1
km distant

Visibility: 9

May 19, 1982; 9 shards

* * *

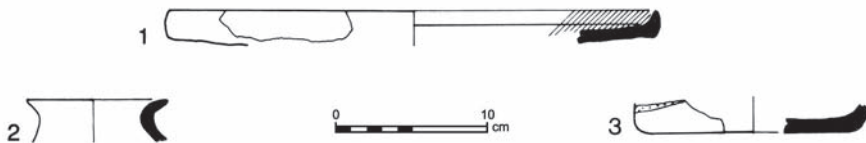
A cairn on a high summit in the mass of Bilam ez-Zef, between Wadi el-Far'ah and the eastern Buqei'ah. There is a fine view of Wadi el-Far'ah and the Beqa'ot area.

The cairn is 11 m in diameter and 2 m high. It is built of large and

medium-sized stones, with remains of walls. Around the cairn are sections of walls, an evidence for a presumed structure or two.

Pottery: EBA I – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



430. Pottery from Ras Bilam ez-Zef (A), all from EBA I: 1. Platter, red slip; 2. Jar, br; 3. HM jar base, gray.

Site 202: 19 – 18/11/2

Ras Bilam ez-Zef (B)

Israel grid: 1913 1813
 UTM grid: 7307 5681
 Elevation: 115 m a.s.l., 120 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: shard scatter and encampment remnants
 Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)
 Topography: high saddle
 Rock type: Judah formation
 Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 5
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 1 km distant
 Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1 km distant
 Visibility: 7
 May 4, 1992; 29 shards

* * *

A large shard scatter on a broad saddle in the heights of the Ras Bilam ez-Zef Range, north of Wadi el-Far'ah. The scatter continues from the saddle to the east.

The remains of walls found in various places on the saddle are the evidence for encampment over long periods. West of the saddle there is a

small structure built of large stones. The grinding stones found in the site are typical to nomads' encampment.

Pottery: EBA I – 10%; IrA II – 30%; Per – 5%; Hel – 15%; Byz – 20%; MA – 20%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 203: 19 – 18/31/1

E.P. 141

Israel grid: 1935 1819
 UTM grid: 7322 5690
 Elevation: 135 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest EP
 Site type: structures and built courtyards
 Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)
 Topography: moderate slope
 Rock type: Judah formation
 Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

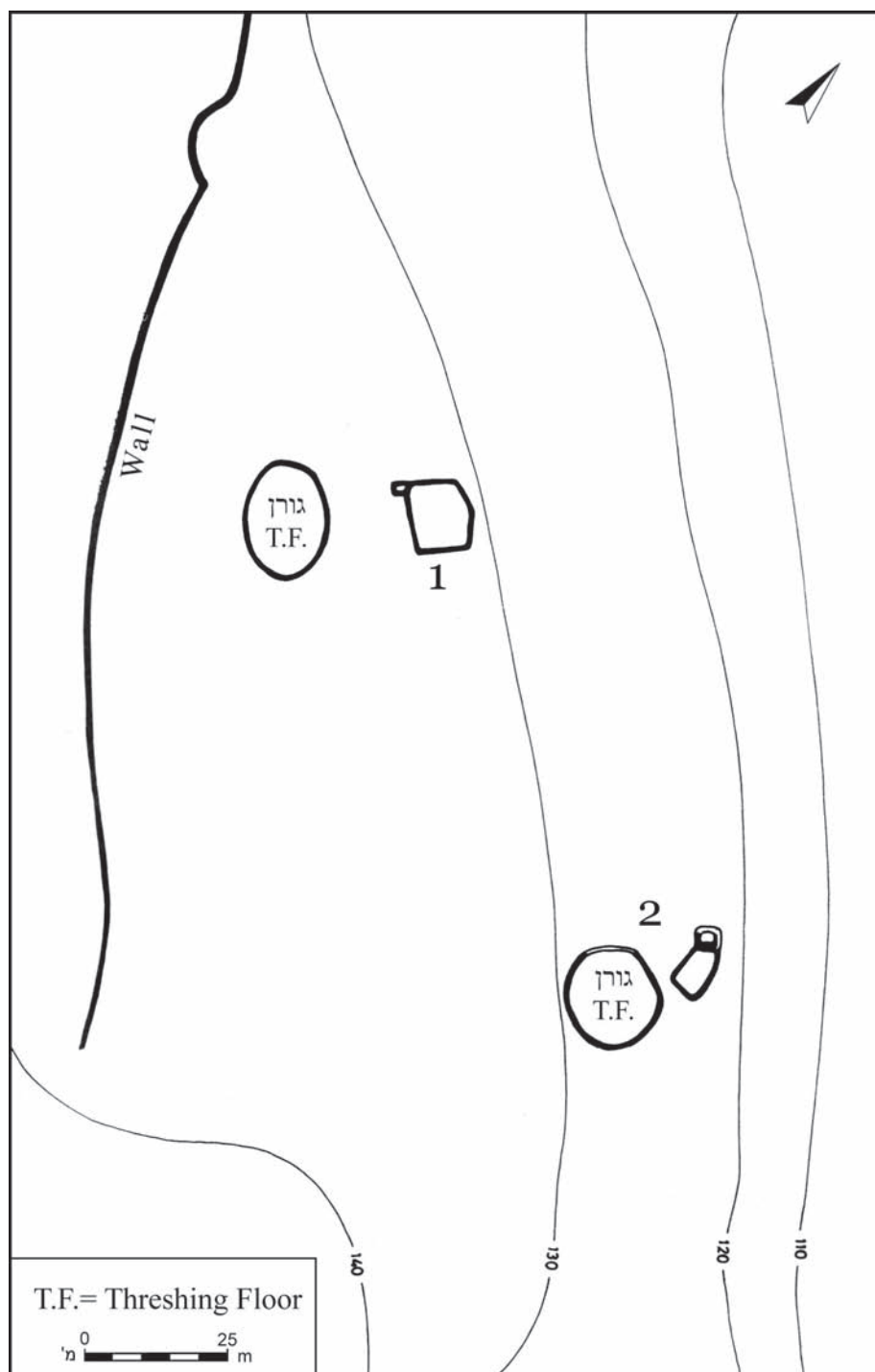
soil; quality: 6
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3 km distant
 Nearest road: Far'ah – Meholah (C23), 1.5 km distant
 Visibility: 4
 Jan. 14, 1994; 22 shards



431. The eastern courtyard at E.P. 141, looking northeast. In background is the summit of the mountain of Umm er-Rkab (Ras Qasm). Winter 1994.



432. The western courtyard at E.P. 141, looking west. In lower right is the ravine of Umm er-Rkab; in background is Moshav Beqa'ot. Winter 1994.



433. The plan of the site at E.P. 141.

Structures and courtyards on the slope of the large hill of E.P. 141, about 1.5 km south-southeast of Beqa'ot.

Two units were discerned, about 90 m distant from each other:

1. An irregular courtyard, 7x10 m in size, built of large field stones. In its western corner is a small, dismantled structure, 4x4 m in size, with especially large building stones.

2. East of it is a smaller, rectangu-

lar courtyard, with a large structure (5x7 m) in its southwest corner.

A round threshing-floor is built close to each structure, and a long wall running along the ridge from northwest to southeast. There are also a *tumulus* and a hewn installation. The site is close by style and masonry to the farms of 'Iraq el-Hamam (sites nos. 36 here).

Pottery: LR – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 204: 19 – 18/41/2

Umm er-Rkab (A) (on SWP map: Khallet Umm Rukab)

Israel grid: 1943 1819

UTM grid: 7335 5691

Elevation: 187 m a.s.l., 200 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: cairn and structure

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina; qual-

ity: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman junction (C21), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 9

May 1, 1992; 15 shards

A cairn and a structure on a high summit of the Umm er-Rkab Range, between the central Buqei'ah and Wadi el-Far'ah. There is an good view to the Buqei'ah.

The cairn, built of large stones, is 7 m in diameter. There probably was a circular tower here, but the fallen stones have rendered the

shape unclear. A long wall arrives to the cairn from the west, descending eastward along the slope. About 0.1 km west of the cairn, beyond a small saddle, are remains of a structure, 5x8 m in size, whose plan is unclear. Beside it, shards from Iron Age II and a few later shards were found.

The central cairn possibly served as a lookout tower. There were few shards, one of which possibly dates to the Chalcolithic period.

Pottery: IrA II – 60%; LR – 40%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 162.



434. A Bedouin encampment in the ravine east of Umm er-Rkab (A), looking north. In background are the southern ranges of the Buqe'ah and the range of Dhahret el-Meidan. 1994.



Site 205: 19 – 18/41/1

Khallet Musah

Israel grid: 1945 1815

UTM grid: 7328 5686

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 45 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm and structure

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina; qual-

ity: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Buqe'ah – Argaman junction (C21), 2 km distant

Visibility: 3

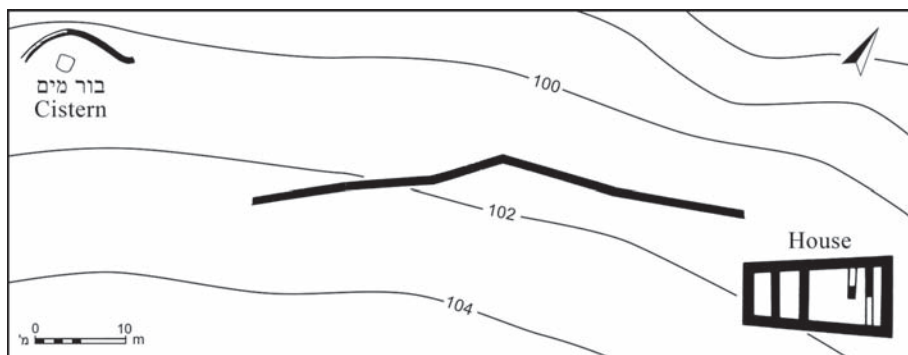
May 1, 1992; 30 shards

A farm on a ridge in the Umm er-Rkab Range, between the central Buqei'ah and Wadi el-Far'ah.

The farm is situated on a ridge southeast of the summit of Ras Qasm (E.P. 187), with a cultivated ravine to its north. The central part of the site is a structure 6x15

m in size, built of large stones. It contains two rooms and a courtyard with secondary division. To its west, 60 m away, are a terrace wall and a hewn cistern.

About 50 m south of the site there are possible remains of more structures.



435. Plan of the site of Khallet Musah. At right is the farmhouse; at left is the cistern.



436. The farm structure at Khallet Musah, viewed from the north. May 1993.

Pottery: IrA II – 60%; LR – 40%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 163. They apparently discovered the site, but incor-

rectly identified its exact location, and they make no mention of the Iron Age II shards.



Site 206: 19 – 18/20/1

Qasr Mikser

Israel grid: 1924 1806

UTM grid: 7307 5674

Elevation: 20 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: historical but not on map

Site type: farm and structure

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina; qual-

ity: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 1 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), passes by site

Visibility: 4

May 24, 1982; Mar. 13, 1992; 26 shards

* * *

A structure and a courtyard, between Ras Bilam ez-Zef and the road from Wadi el-Far'ah to Meholah, 2.5 km south of Beqa'ot.

Beside a structure of large stones, 4x4 m in size, there is a circular

courtyard. Around the site are a large shard scatter and agricultural installations.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.

Site 207: 19 – 18/31/2

Wadi ej-Jurn

Israel grid: 1938 1810
 UTM grid: 7320 5682
 Elevation: 60 m a.s.l., 2 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: encampment
 Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)
 Topography: wadi gorge
 Rock type: Judah formation
 Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterra-

nean brown forest soil; quality: 3
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
 (no. 104), 2 km distant
 Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Me-
 holah (C23), 1 km distant
 Visibility: 2
 Jan. 21, 1994; 25 shards

* * *

Remains of an encampment next to the gorge of Wadi ej-Jurn, 2.5 km south of Beqa'ot.

On a low step, adjacent to the wadi gorge, two kidney-shaped circles of stones were found. The leveled step, also used by the Bed-

ouins, is protected by a terrace wall running along the gorge. Among other finds, there is a grinding stone of basalt.

Pottery: Byz – 5%; MA – 60%; Ott – 35%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 208: 19 – 18/40/1

Habis 'Id

Israel grid: 1943 1808
 UTM grid: 7329 5675
 Elevation: 80 m a.s.l., l.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: small site
 Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)
 Topography: ridge at edge of plateau
 Rock type: Judah formation
 Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 7

Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
 (no. 104), 3 km distant
 Nearest road: Buqe'ah – Argaman
 junction (C21), 2 km distant
 Visibility: 5
 Jan. 14, 1994; 79 shards

* * *

A small site on the southern edge of the plateau, south of the Umm er-Rkab Range.

At least three structures once

stood at the site, of which only piles of stones remained with fragments of walls. Of the central structure, medium-sized stones are seen. East

of the structures are two stone circles, 8 m in diameter each.

The site appears to have been a farm or seasonal structures, connected with cultivation of the nearby areas and with animal hus-

bandry.

Pottery: IrA II – 62%; Hel – 4%; LR – 34%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 165.



437. The site at Habis 'Id, looking east. In the background are Ras Humsah and its cliffs. Winter 1994.

Site 209: 19 – 18/30/1

Wadi Habis 'Id

Israel grid: 1936 1807

UTM grid: 7319 5675

Elevation: 10 m a.s.l., 7 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest
soil and terra rossa; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 2 km distantNearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1.5
km distant

Visibility: 4

Jan. 21, 1994; 47 shards

* * *

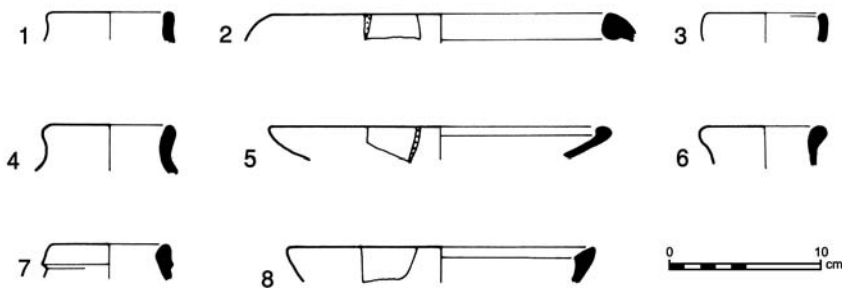
A structure on a rock step above a low cliff in Wadi Habis 'Id, 3 km south-southwest of Beqa'ot.

This is a long, well-built structure on top of the cliff. The western wall, the best preserved one, is built of two rows of medium-sized stones, and is 1 m wide and 21 m long. Parallel to it, 9 m away, is the eastern wall. It is 36 m long and

mostly in ruins. The wall connecting the two is in the south side of the structure and is 0.45 m wide. At the bottom of the cliff, in the east, a rock shelter was found, closed by a later wall. A small shard scatter was found on the site.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 95%; LR – 5%.

Previous surveys: none.



438. Pottery from Wadi Habis 'Id: nos. 2, 5, 8 – MBA II; the rest – LR: 1, 3-4, 6-7. Jars, lt br and dk inside; 2. CP, bl; 5, 8. Bowls, lt.



439. Wadi Habis 'Id, looking north. The wadi descends southward to Wadi el-Far'ah. The site is above the cliff at left.



Site 210: 19 – 17/48/1

Khirbet el-Mutaqallabat

Israel grid: 1948 1781

UTM grid: 7331 5651

Elevation: 10 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: on map as historical site

Site type: small site

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Wadi el-
Far'ah (C24), passes by site

Visibility: 4

Jan. 21, 1994; 60 shards

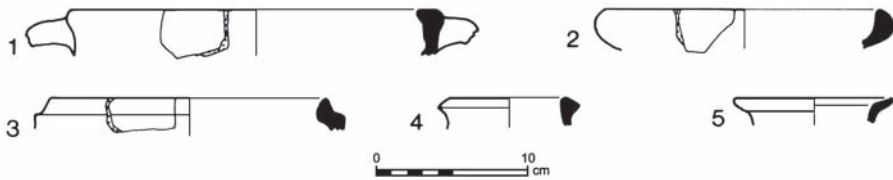
A site in ruins on the western edge of Mutaqallabat Valley, near an army base and adjacent to Wadi Mutaqallabat.

Only a wall 2 m wide, built of large stones, presumably part of a large enclosure, has survived of the site. The site was destroyed by bull-

dozers in the 1980's.

30%; Byz – 10%.

Pottery: IrA II – 60%; IrA III – *Previous surveys:* none.



440. Pottery from Kh. el-Mutaqallabat, all from IrA II-III except for no. 2, 5: 1, 3. CP, br; 2. Bowl, br, IrA I; 4. Jug, dk; 5. Jar, lt br, Byz.



Site 211: 19 – 17/68/2

Wadi 'Abd el-'Al

Israel grid: 1960 1783

UTM grid: 7349 5645

Elevation: 48 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure and shard scatter

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: brown alluvium; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman
Junction (C21), 2 km distant

Visibility: 4

Mar. 20, 1992; 34 shards

A site on a step on the eastern edge of Ras Humsah, next to the path to Kh. Umm Hajar. From the site is a fine view of Mutaqallabat Valley.

The site compose the remains of an elliptical enclosure, 20x12 m in size. The enclosure wall was built of large stones, that has survived in several sections. In the missing sections a low, dirt rampart with small stones remains. In several places,

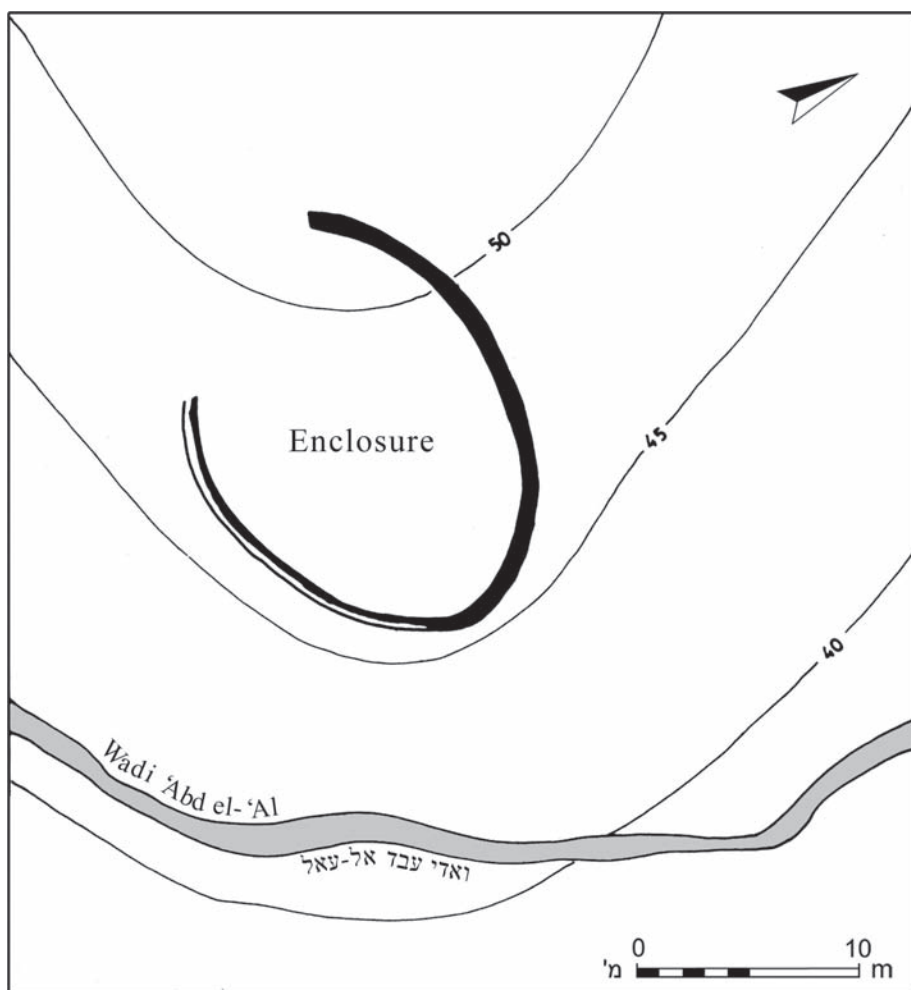
there are walls and bases of contemporary Bedouin encampments.

This enclosure and nomads-encampment was in use over long periods. Many sites of this type are in the desert fringes of the Manasseh.

Pottery: Chal – 3%; IrA IA – 31%; Hel – 8%; LR – 13%; Byz – 5%; MA – 27%; Mod – 13%.

Flint find: two undefined items.

Previous surveys: none.



441. Plan of the enclosure in Wadi 'Abd el-'Al.



442. The enclosure in Wadi 'Abd el-'Al, viewed from the east, with Ras Humsah above it. Winter 1992.



Site 212: 19 – 17/68/1

Khirbet Umm Dhabeh (Umm Hajar)

Israel grid: 1968 1783

UTM grid: 7352 5649

Elevation: 40 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: farm

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: low ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3.5 km distant

Nearest road: Buqe'ah – Argaman Junction (C21), 1 km distant

Visibility: 4

May 8, 1983; Feb. 11, 1992; 33 shards

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A site on a saddle, near a good pass from Wadi el-Far'ah to the eastern Buqe'ah, and about 1.5 km west of Kh. Umm Kharaz. There is a

view of the eastern Buqe'ah, the Jordan Valley and the valley of Wadi el-Far'ah.

The site contains two main parts:

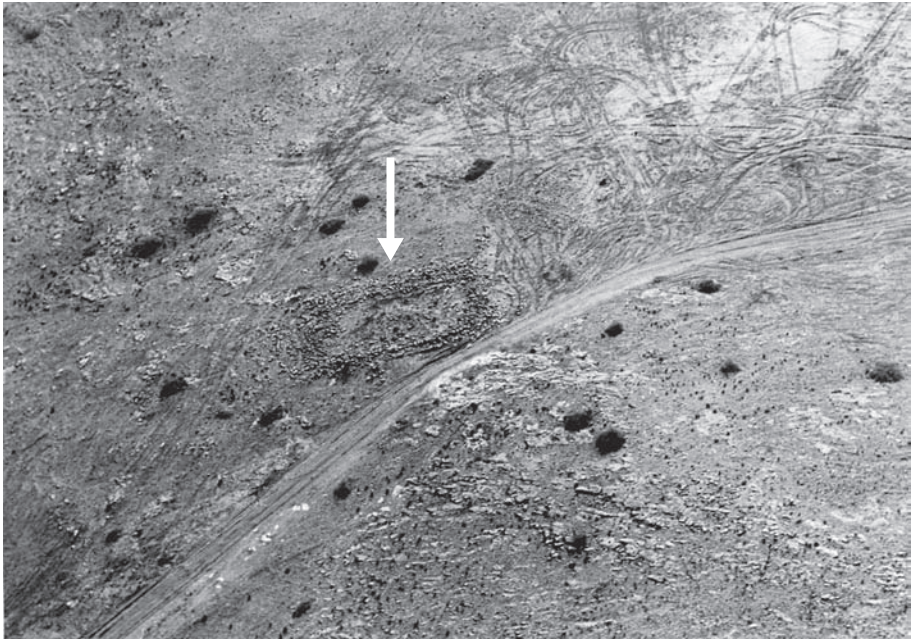
1. A large, rectangular courtyard, about 17x25 m in size. Its walls are built of large field stones, each averaging 40x40 cm in size. The western and southeastern walls are built with two rows of stones, whereas the northern and southern has one row of large stones. Parts of the walls still stand to two courses, or about 1 m, high. There are remains of a building, east of the courtyard, which probably have preceded it and dismantled. A short wall leaves the southern corner but has no continuation; it seems to have been built at a later date than the courtyard itself.

2. Some 20 m south of the courtyard a structure with few surviving walls is discerned; its eastern wall is 13 m long and 0.4 m wide. It seems to have been a dwelling place, but is now covered by a pile of cleared stones.

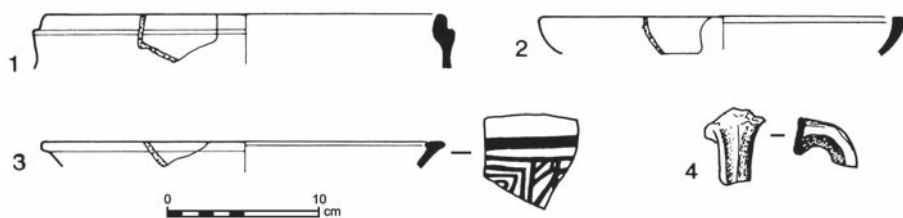
The site was founded during Iron Age II (8th-7th Centuries BCE), with a farm, of the Byzantine Period, on top of it. The large courtyard dates to the latter time. Other Byzantine Period courtyards have been found in the Manasseh fringes.

Pottery: IrA II – 21%; Byz – 75%; MA – 4%.

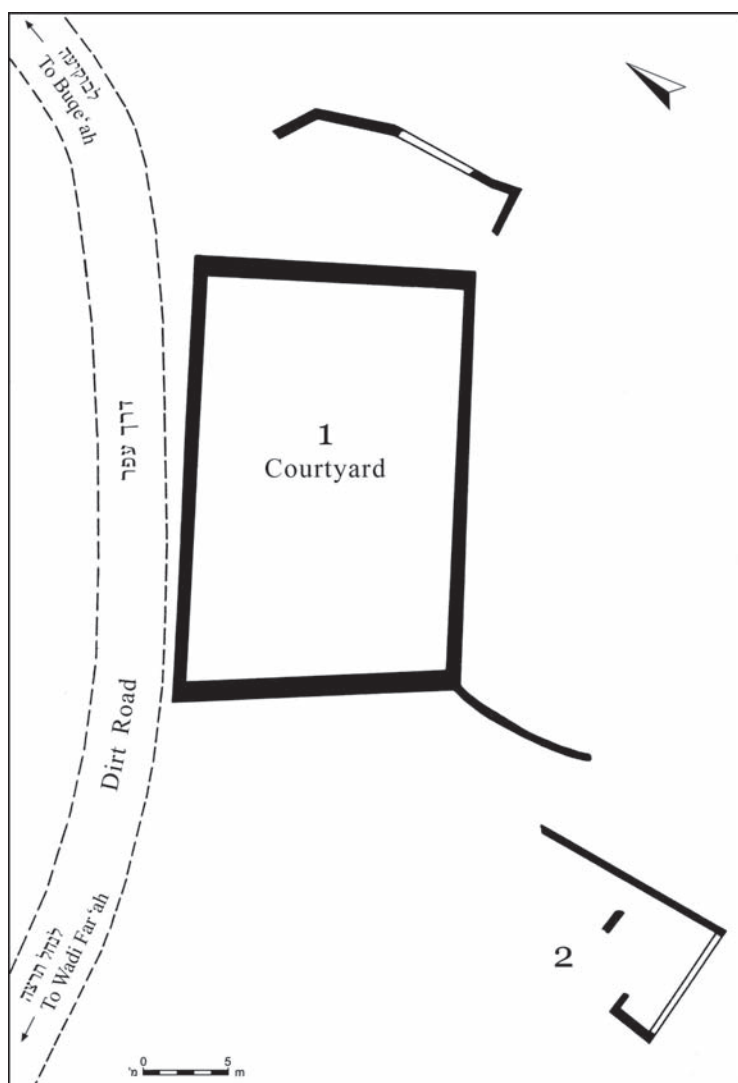
Previous surveys: none.



443. Umm Dhabeh as seen from a bird's eye view, from the west (arrow). The road leads right to the Buqei'ah and left to Wadi el-Far'ah. Winter 1993.



444. Pottery from Umm Dhabeḥ: 1. CP, br, IrA II; 2. Bowl, lt br, Byz; 3. Bowl, br dec on wh, MA; 4. Handle, br, Byz.



445. Plan of the enclosure and buildings at Umm Dhabeḥ.

Site 213: 19 – 17/57/1

Khirbet ej-Jofeh

Israel grid: 1952 1776

UTM grid: 7334 5643

Elevation: 30 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: historical site but does not appear on map

Site type: fortress and structure

Area: 1.5 dunams (0.38 acre)

Topography: low hilltop on valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 1.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 3

May 8, 1983; Feb. 28, 1992, 41 shards

A site on the low hills between Ras Humsah in the north and Wadi el-Far'ah in the south, with a view of Ras Khubezah and Ras Humsah. It is situated at the edge of Mutaqalla-

bat Valley, near the road from Wadi el-Far'ah to the eastern Buqe'ah.

There are two main parts in the place:



446. Kh. ej-Jofeh, looking northwest. The figures stand on the remains of the square structure; in background are Mutaqallabat Valley and the eastern part of Ras Humsah. 1994.

1. A square structure, 13x13 m in size, with a separate unit in the north, perhaps for living quarters. Its southern part is a sort of inner courtyard. Two building stages are discernible: the earlier is of small stones, with walls of large, partially hewn stones on top of it. This may express two periods.

2. The western unit is a round structure (a tower?) whose outer diameter is 14 m. It contains three concentric circular walls, 1 m distance between them. The inner circle is 7 m in diameter. Between the two units, nos. 1 and 2 above, is a connecting wall, about 0.6 m wide.

This site is architecturally similar to the round fortresses of the

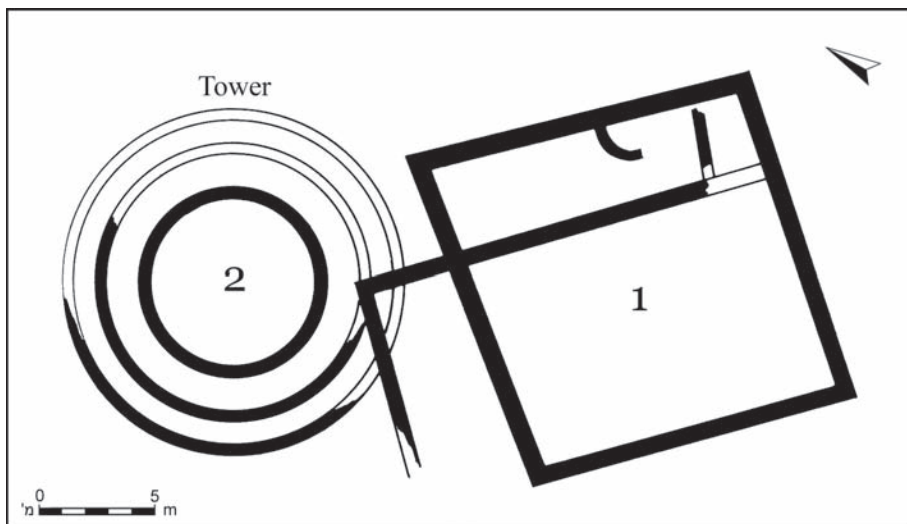
'Malfuf' type, found at Kh. esh-Shaqq, el-Makhruq and Rujum Abu Muheir. All these are fortresses with three concentric circles and a square structure next to it. The resemblance to the Ammonite round towers is apparent.

A place in the name of Kh. Jofeh appears on the map near the Mechorah Junction, next to Wadi el-Far'ah. However, no ancient site exist on this spot. Site 213 appears on previous maps as "Murhan Zafiyeh".

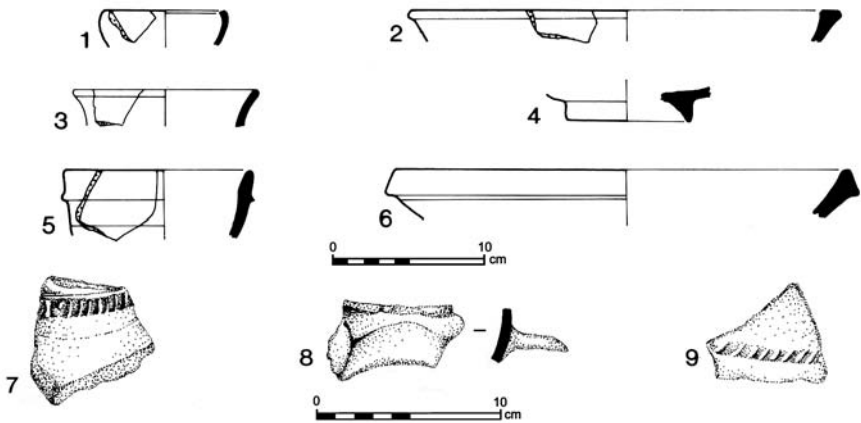
Pottery: MBA I – 5%; IrA II – 30%; Byz – 15%; MA – 50%.

Special find: fragment of a basalt mace head.

Previous surveys: none.



447. Plan of the site at Kh. ej-Jofeh. Note the round tower and the later, square unit.



448. Pottery from Kh. ej-Jofeh, 2-4, 6 – IrA II; 1, 5 – Byz; 7-9 – MBA I: 1. Jug, br; 2. Bowl, yel; 3. Jar, br; 4. Bowl base, gray; 5. Jar, lt br; 6. Bowl, br; 7-9. Rope dec and ledge handle, yel.



Site 214: 19 – 17/67/1

Khirbet Umm Hajar (B)

Israel grid: 1969 1778

UTM grid: 7351 5649

Elevation: 70 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 0.3 dunam (0.08 acre)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman Junction (C21), 1 km distant

Visibility: 4

Mar. 7, 1992; 11 shards

A structure at the edge of a high ridge on the southeastern edge of the Buqei'ah, between Ras Humsah and Ras Umm Khubezah.

There is a solitary structure, built of unhewn field stones, with discernible walls but unclear plan. A medium-sized amount of shards

was collected on the eastern slope, below the structure. From a fragment of a cooking pot found there, the site was dated to an early stage of Iron Age II (10th Century BCE?).

Pottery: IrA II – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.

Site 215: 19 – 17/77/1

esh-Shamekh

Israel grid: 1971 1779

UTM grid: 7353 5645

Elevation: 35 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 3.5 km distant

Nearest road: Buqe'ah – Argaman

Junction (C21), 1 km distant

Visibility: 3

Mar. 13, 1992; 20 shards

* * *

A site at the edge of the eastern Buqe'ah, about 1 km west of Kh. Umm Kharaz and near the pass linking the Buqe'ah with Mutaqalabat Valley. Above it, to the west, towers the Shamekh Range.

The site is comprised of four parts:

1. A round circle, 7.5 m in diameter, built of one row of stones. Next to it there are possible remains of more circles, larger than the first one.

2. A rectangular structure, built of large stones, 4x6 m in size, is placed



449. The figures stand on the site of esh-Shamekh, viewed to the south. In the background is part of the eastern Buqe'ah and the ranges of Umm Kharubeh and Umm Khubezah. Winter 1994.

3 m west of the round circle.

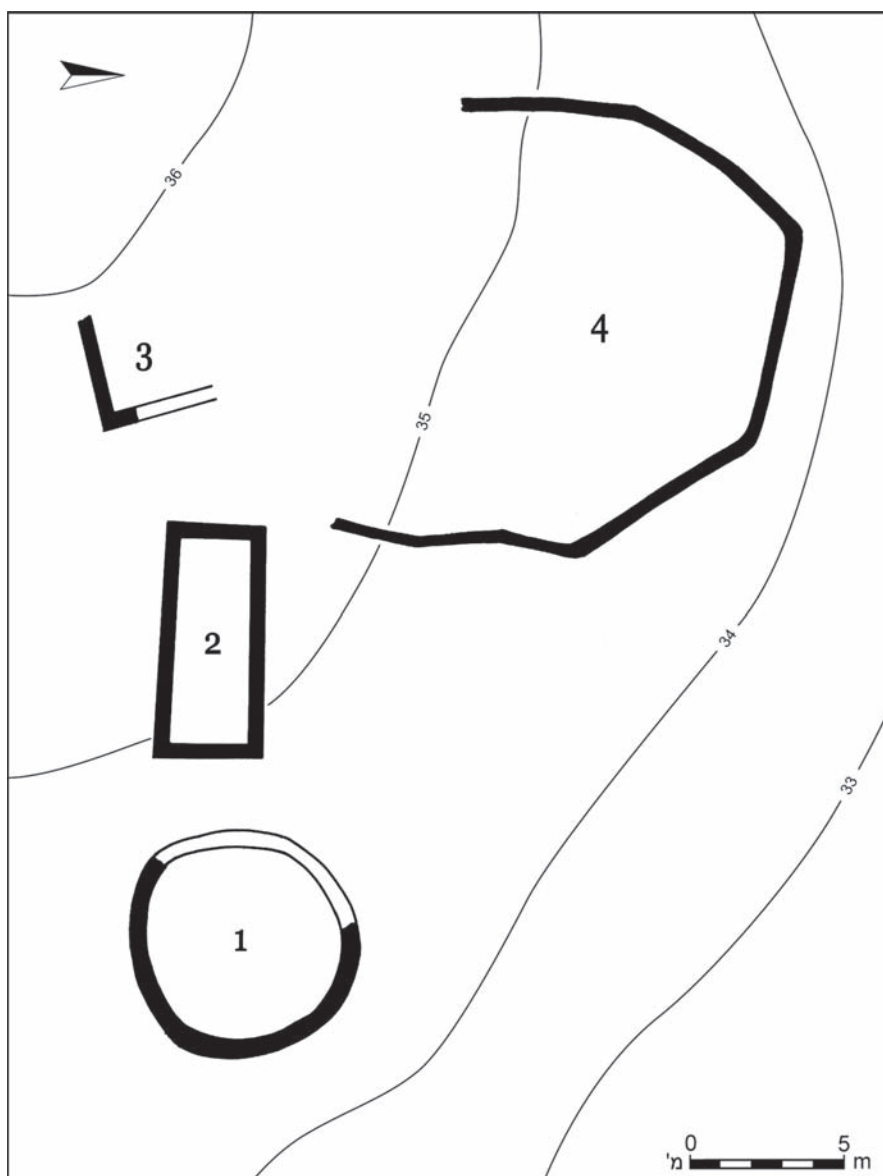
3. A part of a small structure, of whose only a corner remained, is to the west of the above.

4. A large courtyard surrounded by a stone wall, whose southern

half is missing. In spite of the missing stones it seems to surround the entire courtyard.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



450. Plan of the site at esh-Shamekh.

Site 216: 19 – 17/67/2

E.P. 11

Israel grid: 1963 1773

UTM grid: 7344 5645

Elevation: 11 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest EP

Site type: structure and shard scatter

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman Junction (C21), 1 km distant

Visibility: 3

Mar. 7, 1992; 18 shards

* * *

A site on a low ridge in the middle of Mutaqallabat Valley, close to a small wadi that drains the northern valley. Near it, to the south, are training trenches and bunkers.

One square structure, built of large stones, about 5x5 m in size, is on the site. Around it is a shard

scatter over an area of 2 dunams (0.5 acre). There may have been more structures at the site that were destroyed due to military activity.

Pottery: IrA II – 25%; Byz – 40%; Mod – 35%.

Previous surveys: none.



451. Remains of the site at E.P. 11. In background is Mutaqallabat Valley. 1994.

Site 217: 19 – 17/56/2

Khallet el-Khanakhneh (A)

Israel grid: 1957 1769

UTM grid: 7340 5642

Elevation: s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: prehistoric

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman Junction (C21), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 2

Mar. 7, 1992; 58 flint items

* * *

A site on the edge of the eastern slope of a ravine that descends northwards to Mutaqallabat Valley. Its surface was damaged by bulldozers activity. There are no building

remains, but a large flint scatter.

Flint find: Middle Paleolithic; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 218: 19 – 17/57/3

Khallet el-Khanakhneh (B)

Israel grid: 1958 1771

UTM grid: 7341 5641

Elevation: s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: courtyard/enclosure

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina; qual-

ity: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman Junction (C21), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 2

Mar. 7, 1992; 28 shards

* * *

A built courtyard on the eastern edge of Mutaqallabat Valley, which joins the eastern Buqei'ah and Wadi el-Far'ah.

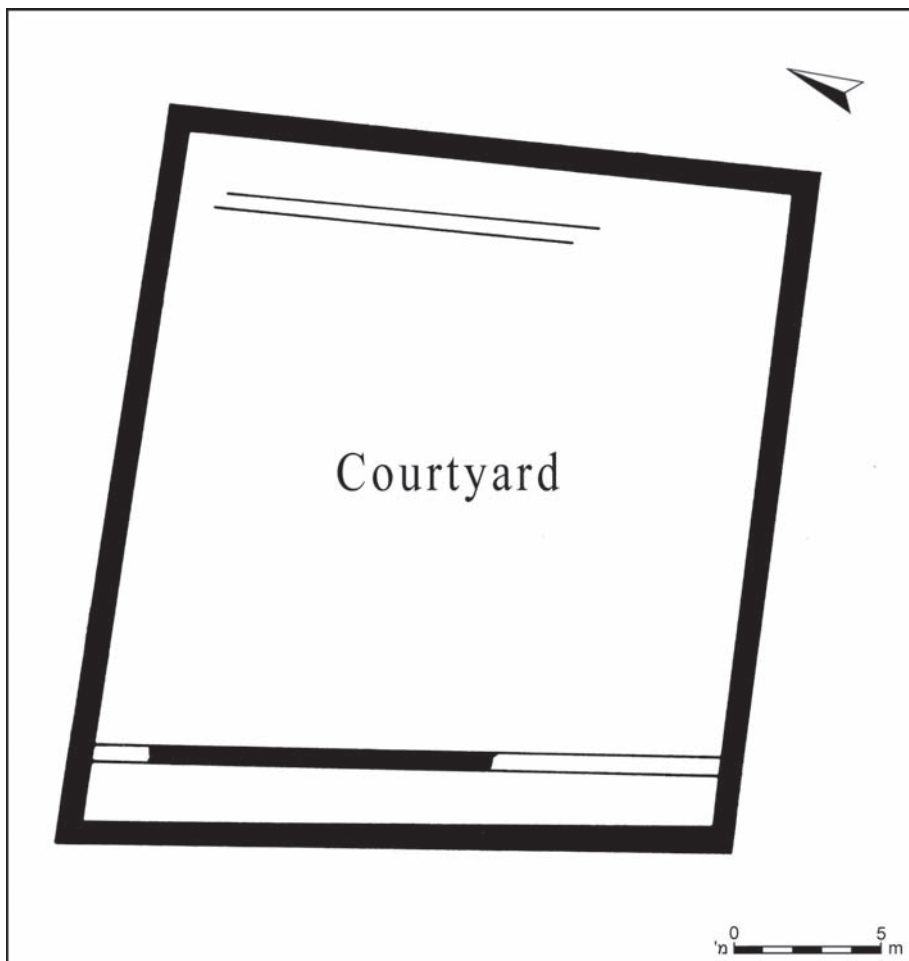
There is a large courtyard on a moderate slope, slightly above the valley edge. The courtyard, 22x24 m in size, is surrounded by a wall

0.6-0.7 m wide of large, partially hewn stones, some in upright position. The eastern wall is three stone-courses high. On the western side of the courtyard a parallel wall creates a long hall, about 5 m wide, with possible rooms. On the

eastern side are a few remnants of a similar wall. The site is yet another in a row of Byzantine Period courtyards in the region.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



452. The courtyard plan at Khallet el-Khanakhneh (B).



453. View to the east of the built courtyard at Khallet el-Khanakhneh (B). The remains of the courtyard are visible on the lower part of the slope. The source of flint of Ras el-Kharubeh was discovered on this ridge. Winter 1992.



Site 219: 19 – 17/77/2

Ras Umm Khubezah

Israel grid: 1977 1773

UTM grid: 7361 5644

Elevation: 35 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin and shard scatter

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 4.5 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman Junction (C21), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 4

Feb. 25, 1992; 46 shards and 51 flint items

* * *

A site on the northern bottoms of Ras Umm Khubezah, about 1 km southwest of Kh. Umm Kharaz. There is a good view to the eastern

Buqei'ah and the Jordan Valley.

The site is located on the eastern slope of a small hilltop, with a round tower at the summit above, 7

m in diameter and built of one row of large, hewn stones. These have been preserved in some places to a height of two courses. The site, located on elevated surface, contains two parts:

1. On a saddle, about 0.1 km west of the site, is a rock surface 30x30 m in size. In its southwest corner there is a wall of hewn stones, built along the edge of the rock surface. On the surface there are several basins. Probably for grinding.

2. In a small wadi nearby the remains of several rectangular buildings, with plans unclear, were dis-

cerned. On an area of 2 dunams (0.5 acre) around the buildings are a medium-sized shard scatter and many flint items. Aside from the flint tools, basalt stones for grinding and procession were also found. Apparently there were also encampments on the spot.

Pottery: MBA II – 30%; IrA II – 30%; Roman-Byz – 30%; Ott – 2%; Mod – 8%.

Flint find: Natufian, Pre-Pottery, Neolithic B, Chal, MBA II and IrA Age (items); see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



454. The upper part of the site of Umm Khubezah, looking north. In background is the hilltop with round tower. On the southern slope is rock surface with hewn installations. Spring 1994.

Site 220: 19 – 17/46/1

Wadi Umm el-Khazam

Israel grid: 1947 1764

UTM grid: 7330 5635

Elevation: 30 m b.s.l., 10 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 1.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1.5
km distant

Visibility: 1

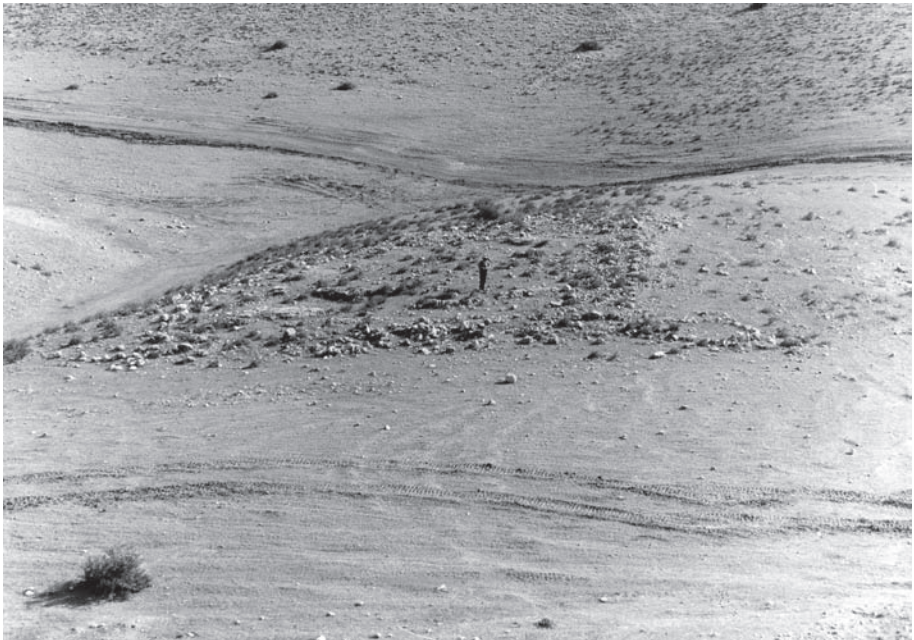
Apr. 22, 1992; 53 shards

* * *

A fortified farm on a slope in the hilly area between the valley of Jeb-el-Muspah and Wadi el-Far'ah.

The farm consists of a courtyard, 23x24 m in size, built of large stones. Inside it there are the

remains of a series of rooms along the northwestern wall, with possible remains of similar rooms along the other walls. A small, trapezoidal structure, built of stone, was found near and outside of the southern



455. The site at Wadi Umm el-Khazam, looking north. Remains of the farm are on the left side of the hill, where the figure stands. In background: the low range of Ras Kharubeh. 1994.

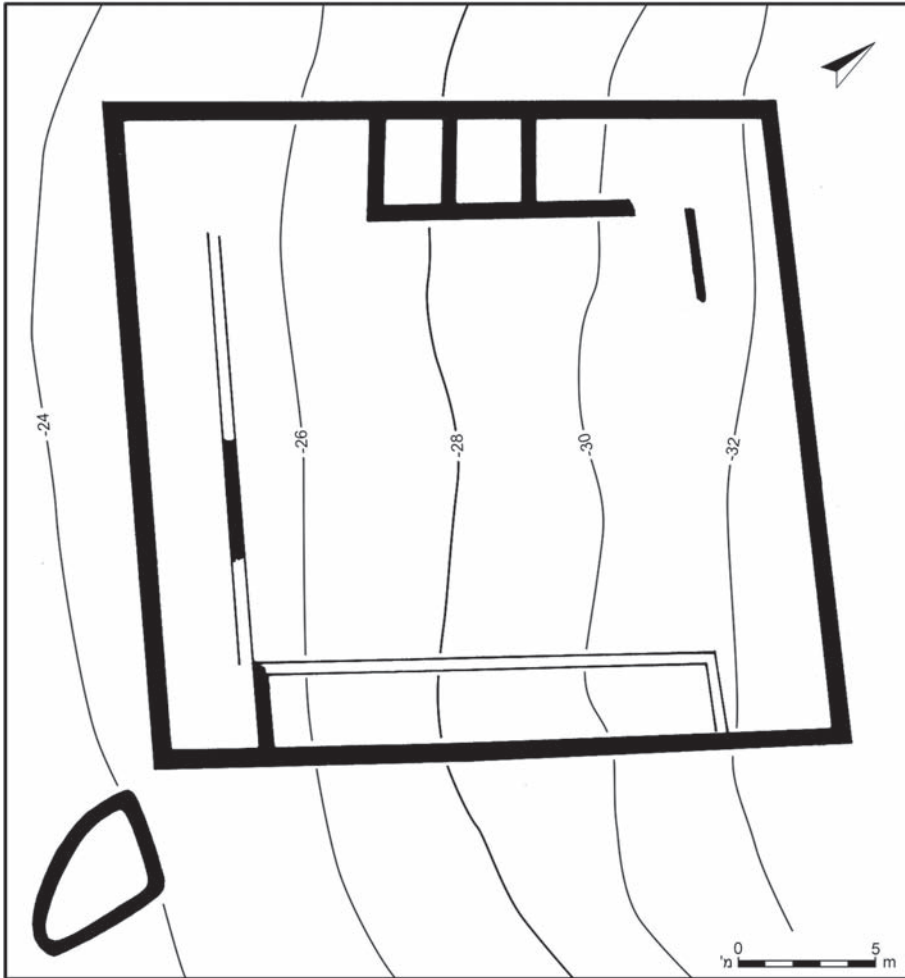
corner.

The plan here resembles the *castellum*-type Roman fortresses of the period, but its location points to a

fortified farm.

Pottery: LR – 70%; Byz – 30%.

Previous surveys: none.



456. Plan of the fortified farm (?) at Wadi Umm el-Khazam. Note the rooms along the walls.

Site 221: 19 – 17/66/1

Khirbet Ras el-Kharubeh

Israel grid: 1966 1766

UTM grid: 7349 5635

Elevation: 70 m b.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: encampment and shard scatter

Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil and mountainous rendzina; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman Junction (C21), 1.25 km distant

Visibility: 2

Feb. 25, 1992; 20 shards

* * *

A site in a ravine, on either side of a small wadi, which descends from the range of Ras el-Kharubeh to Mutaqallabat Valley.

On the west side of the small wadi were found three, elliptically-shaped tent bases, built of field stones. In the area of the encampment and around it a shard scatter was found; no earlier architecture was discovered. The shard scatter

was medium-sized (63 body fragments, aside from the 20 that were sorted). Apparently the site was a permanent or semi-nomadic settlement place, on which tents were pitched.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 16%; IrA I – 11%; IrA II – 26%; Byz – 21%; MA – 26%.

Previous surveys: none.

Site 222: 19 – 17/76/1

Khirbet Naqb el-Matar

Israel grid: 1973 1767

UTM grid: 7355 5638

Elevation: 25 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient but does not appear on map

Site type: fortress and tower

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: saddle and pass

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman junction (C21), passes by site

Visibility: 6

Mar. 13, 1992; May 1, 1992; 10 shards

* * *

A tower or fortress in a pass between Argaman (near the Jordan Valley) and Mutaqallabat Valley. This is the easily accessible road between the two valleys.

There is a round tower here, similar to the Iron Age fortresses at Kh. esh-Shaqq, el-Makhruq, and Rujum Abu Muheir. In the center is an internal circle 10 m in diam-



457. A view looking north at the fortress of Naqb el-Matar. The jeep is on the road from the Buqei'ah to the Jordan Valley. Behind the fortress is Ras Umm Khubezah. 1992.

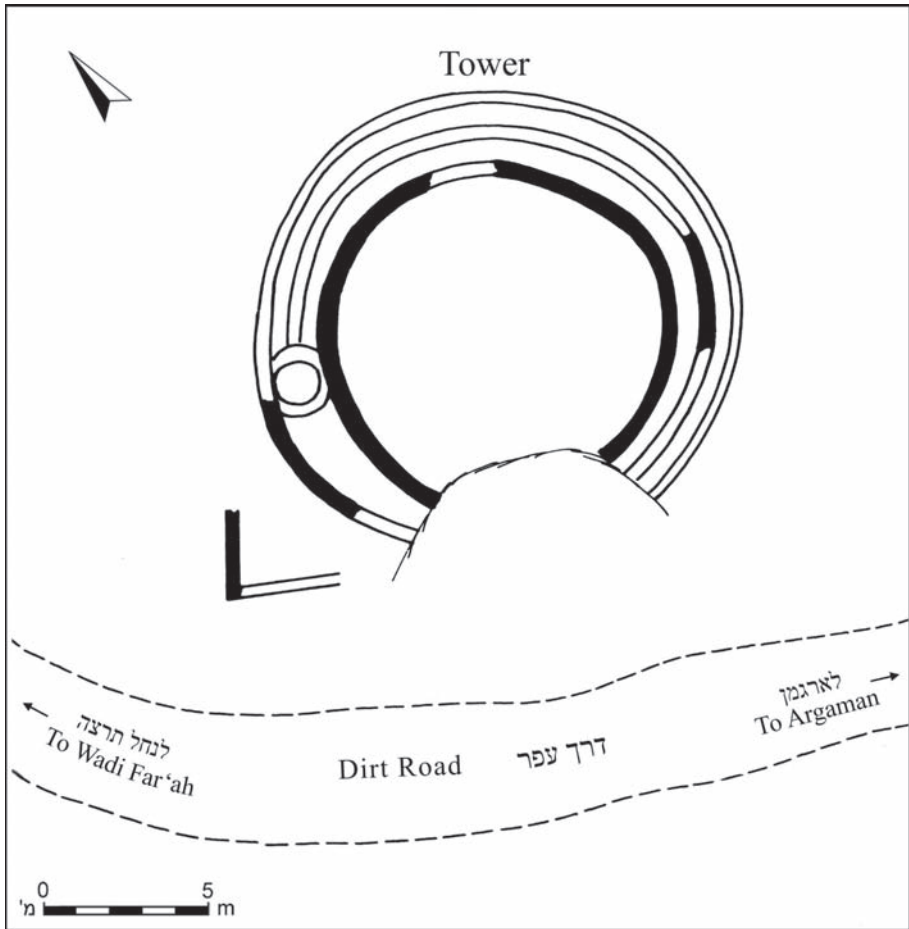
eter. Outside there are the remains of more circles. In the southwest is an angle of walls, presumably of a nearby structure.

The plan and location makes this site a roadside fortress to guard the pass. It seems to be built during

Iron Age II and was in use during the Roman-Byzantine Period as well. Shards are few.

Pottery: IrA II – 80%; Roman-Byz – 20%.

Previous surveys: none.



458. Plan of the fortress (round tower of Ammonite type) at Naqb el-Matar.

Site 223: 19 – 17/56/1

Jebel el-Mssafh (A)

Israel grid: 1951 1761
 UTM grid: 7325 5632
 Elevation: 30 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: small site and structures
 Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)
 Topography: high hilltop and valley edge
 Rock type: Judah formation
 Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 6
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 1 km distant
 Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1 km distant
 Visibility: 8
 Apr. 22, 1992; 18 shards

* * *

A site on a hilltop at the edge of Ms-safh Valley, between the Buqe'ah and Wadi el-Far'ah, with a fine view of Wadi el-Far'ah, the river delta and the Jordan Valley.

There is a small structure of large stones, 4x4 m in size. North of it is

another structure, 10x10 m in size, with at least two walls, one of which is two stones wide (1 m).

Pottery: IrA II – 70%; Byz – 15%; MA: 15%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 224: 19 – 17/55/2

Jebel el-Mssafh (B)

Israel grid: 1954 1758
 UTM grid: 7326 5625
 Elevation: 25 m b.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: fortress (?)
 Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)
 Topography: high hilltop and valley edge
 Rock type: Judah formation
 Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

and stony-desert soil; quality: 3
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 1 km distant
 Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1 km distant
 Visibility: 8
 Apr. 22, 1992; 51 shards

* * *

A site on a hilltop at the edge of Ms-safh Valley, between the Buqe'ah and Wadi el-Far'ah, with a fine view

of Wadi el-Far'ah and its delta.

Here are remains of a round

structure (a tower?), 10 m in diameter. Its northern wall, one stone wide, has survived in good condition, with more parts around. Within the structure is a round pile of cleared stones, shaped like a tower, in which the original building

stones have been concentrated.

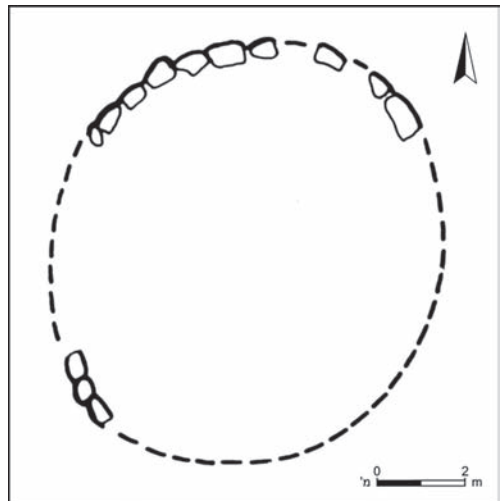
This is, probably, another of the round towers east of Wadi el-Far'ah.

Pottery: IrA II – 34%; Byz – 66%.

Previous surveys: none.



459. A view from the west of the round tower at Jebel el-Mssafh (B). 1994.



460. Plan of the round tower at Jebel el-Mssafh (B).

Site 225: 19 – 17/55/1

el-'Alam (A)

Israel grid: 1951 1755

UTM grid: 7333 5626

Elevation: 50 m b.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site; enclosure

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 1.5 km distantNearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1.5
km distant

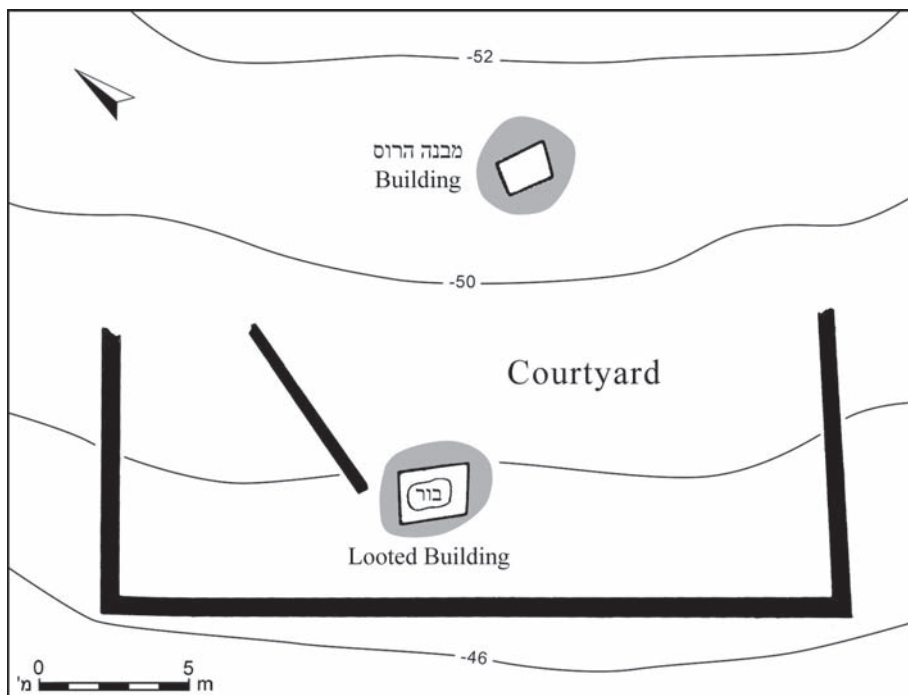
Visibility: 7

Apr. 22, 1992, 45 shards and 20 flint
items

* * *

An enclosure or farm at the edge of Mssafh Valley, between Wadi el-Far'ah and the northern Buqei'ah. Nearby are the remains of a small settlement.

The remains of a partial enclosure, 25 m long and 8 m wide and built of small stones, were found. The northeastern side does not exist. Inside ad to the east are two



461. Plan of the site at el-'Alam (A). The relationship between the enclosure and the structures inside is not clear.

structures, one with a looting pit and a wall to its north. On the path descending into Wadi Umm Watad there are remains of more structures built of large stones. Next to them a road (?), built of two parallel walls and another, large wall at the edge

of the road, was discerned.

Pottery: EBA I – 50%; IrA II – 50%.

Flint find: Chal (mainly); see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 226: 19 – 17/55/3

el-‘Alam (B)

Israel grid: 1955 1755

UTM grid: 7337 5626

Elevation: 50 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site and structure

Area: 0.2 dunam (0.05 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far‘ah (no. 104), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Far‘ah – Jiftliq (B3), 2 km distant

Visibility: 7

Apr. 10, 1992; 17 shards

A site at the edge of Mssafh Valley and above the cliff descending to Wadi el-Far‘ah.

At the site is a single structure of

large stones, 4x4 m in size, with a shard scatter.

Pottery: ER – 50%; LR – 50%.

Previous surveys: none.

Site 227: 19 – 17/55/4

Wadi Ras el-Kharubeh (el-Mrah)

Israel grid: 1956 1757

UTM grid: 7341 5626

Elevation: 50 m b.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure and structures

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 1.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 1.5
km distant

Visibility: 4

Feb. 25, 1992; Apr. 10, 1992; 27
shards

* * *

An enclosure and structures on the edge of Mssafh Valley, an elongated step between Wadi el-Far'ah and the northern Buqei'ah.

At the site is an enclosure, oval and slightly irregular, 35 m in diameter (maximum); the surrounding wall is of two rows of especially

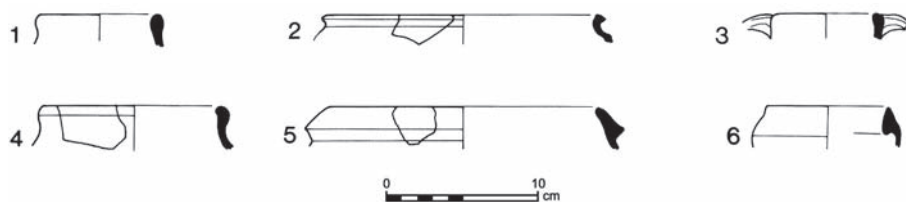
large stones. Two long rooms are attached to its outside from the south. To their east are two more structures with a plan difficult to discern.

Many shards were found at the site, but their identification was difficult.

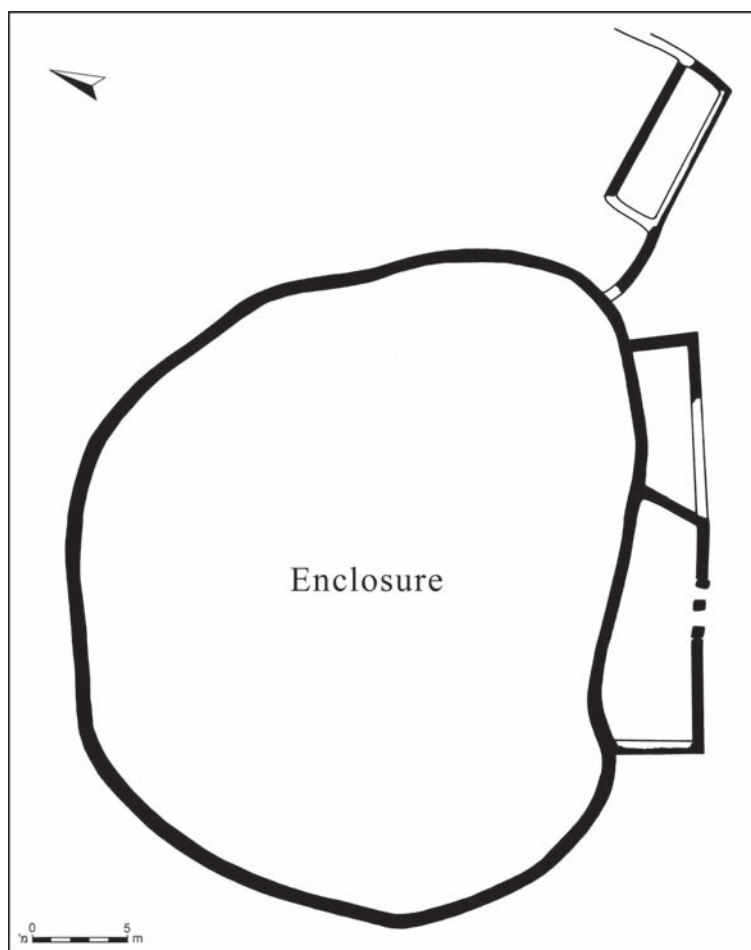


462. View to the west of the enclosure at Wadi Ras el-Kharubeh. At right are the slopes of Ras Kharubeh. Spring 1994.

Pottery: IrA IA-B – 10%; IrA II – 25%; ER – 50%; MA – 15%. **Previous surveys:** none.



463. Pottery from Wadi Ras el-Kharubeh: nos. 1-5 – IrA I-II (stage of period in parentheses); no. 6 – MA: 1. Jug, br (I); 2. CP, dk br (I); 3. Jug, br (II); 4. Jar, yel (II); 5. CP, br (late I); 6. Jar, lt.



464. Plan of the site at Wadi Ras el-Kharubeh.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

THE DESERT FRINGES

LANDSCAPE UNIT 21



Looking south from the heights of Ras Kharubeh, toward Wadi el-Far'ah,
the Jordan Valley and the Sartabah-Alexandrium.

Etching from the British PEFQst 1875, 58.

Site 228: 19 – 19/92/1

Re'us ej-Jibsin

Israel grid: 1992 1929

UTM grid: 7381 5799

Elevation: 20 m b.s.l., 20 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: saddle on plateau

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: mountainous rendzina;

quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 2.5 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), 2 km distant

Visibility: 3

Mar. 6, 1988; 15 shards

* * *

A structure and courtyard in the hilly mass of Re'us ej-Jibsin, 4 km southeast of Meholah.

The structure, 6x7 m in size, is built of large, hewn stones; its interior is divided into two rooms. A courtyard, 8x16 m in size, sur-

rounded by a stone wall and with a cistern inside, is connected to the structure on its eastern side.

The site is a farm or solitary structure.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



465. The structure on the saddle of Re'us ej-Jibsin, looking north. In background are the ranges next to the settlement Rotem.

Site 229: 19 – 19/82/1

‘Ain el-Hilu (A)

Israel grid: 1980 1923

UTM grid: 7361 7593

Elevation: 50 m b.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: high hilltop

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs (‘Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 0.4 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 0.4 km distant

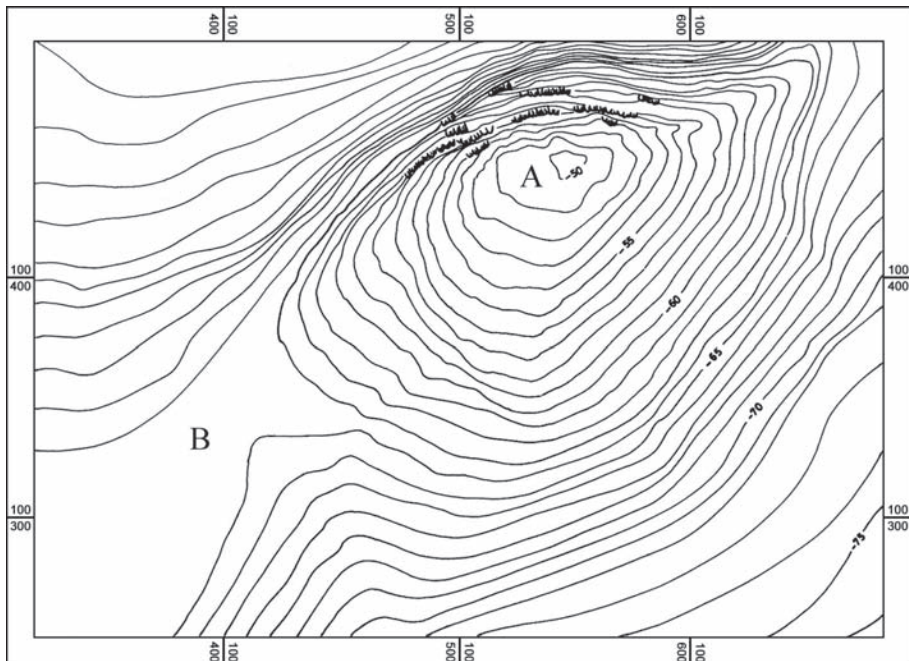
Visibility: 4

Feb. 26, 1988; 18 shards

* * *

A solitary structure on a high hilltop, above and to the east of the junction between the Tubas – Meholah and the Beqa‘ot – Meholah roads. From the site is a good view of Tel el-Hilu and its springs.

The rectangular structure, built of 1 m wide wall of large stones, is 6x12 m in size. In 1988 the structure was excavated to the natural rock, and the quantity of pottery was minimal. This site might have



466. The hill of the sites of ‘Ain el-Hilu. The structure is on the summit (A), and the Chalcolithic Period site (B) is on the southern slope.

served as a lookout post.

Previous surveys: none.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 100%.



467. The fortified structure at 'Ain el-Hilu (A) after its exposure, 1988.



Site 230: 19 – 19/82/2

'Ain el-Hilu (B)

Israel grid: 1981 1922

UTM grid: 7359 5792

Elevation: 63 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin

Area: 12 dunams (3 acres)

Topography: slope and valley edge

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean
brown forest soil; quality: 5

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun
Hilu, no. 88), 0.3 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi Far'ah – Meholah
(C23), 0.3 km distant

Visibility: 3

Feb. 26, 1988; 49 shards and 35 flint
items (aside from material of excava-
tions)

A large settlement on the southern slope of the edge of Maskiyot Val-

ley, above the cliffs descending into 'Ain Hilu and Tel el-Hilu.

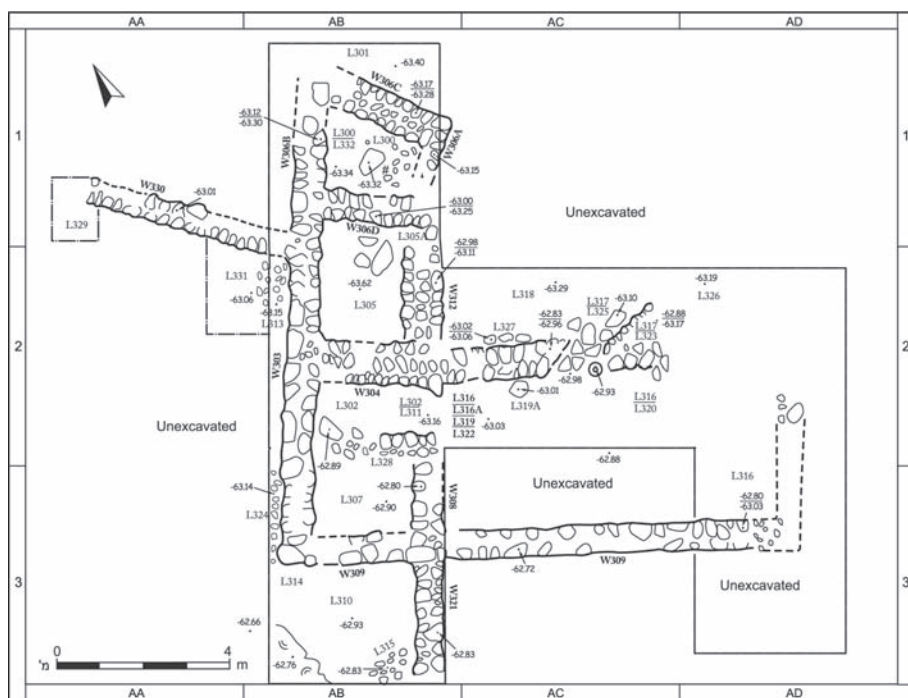
There are about 15-20 structures in the settlement, built of small stones and pebbles. Several large structures, resembling courtyards, are on the upper part of the site; smaller structures are on the lower part.

In 1988 the site was excavated over a two week period by A. Zertal and the Manasseh Hill Country Survey team. Four architectural complexes were exposed in the center of the site, including Chalco-

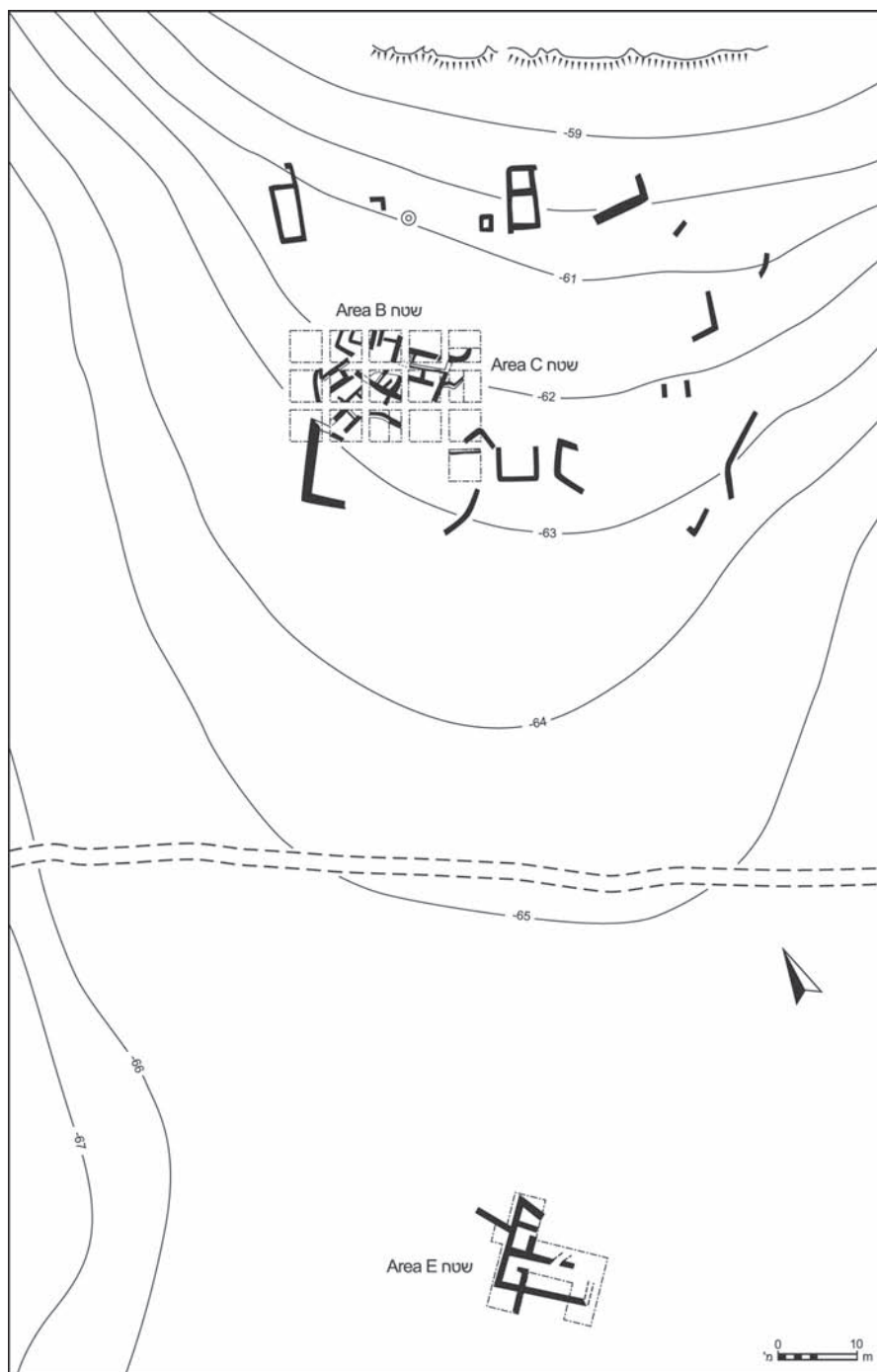
lithic Period broadhouse structure, with the entrance on the short side and the bases for the doorposts. The floors were of packed earth, and in one of the corners an elongated jar with two hole handles was found. Other pottery included "V-shaped" bowls, churns and more. The flint items were few. The excavations were renewed in 2006 under S. Bar.

Pottery: Chal – 100%; for flint find see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



468. 'Ain el-Hilu (B) excavations, Area E. 2006.



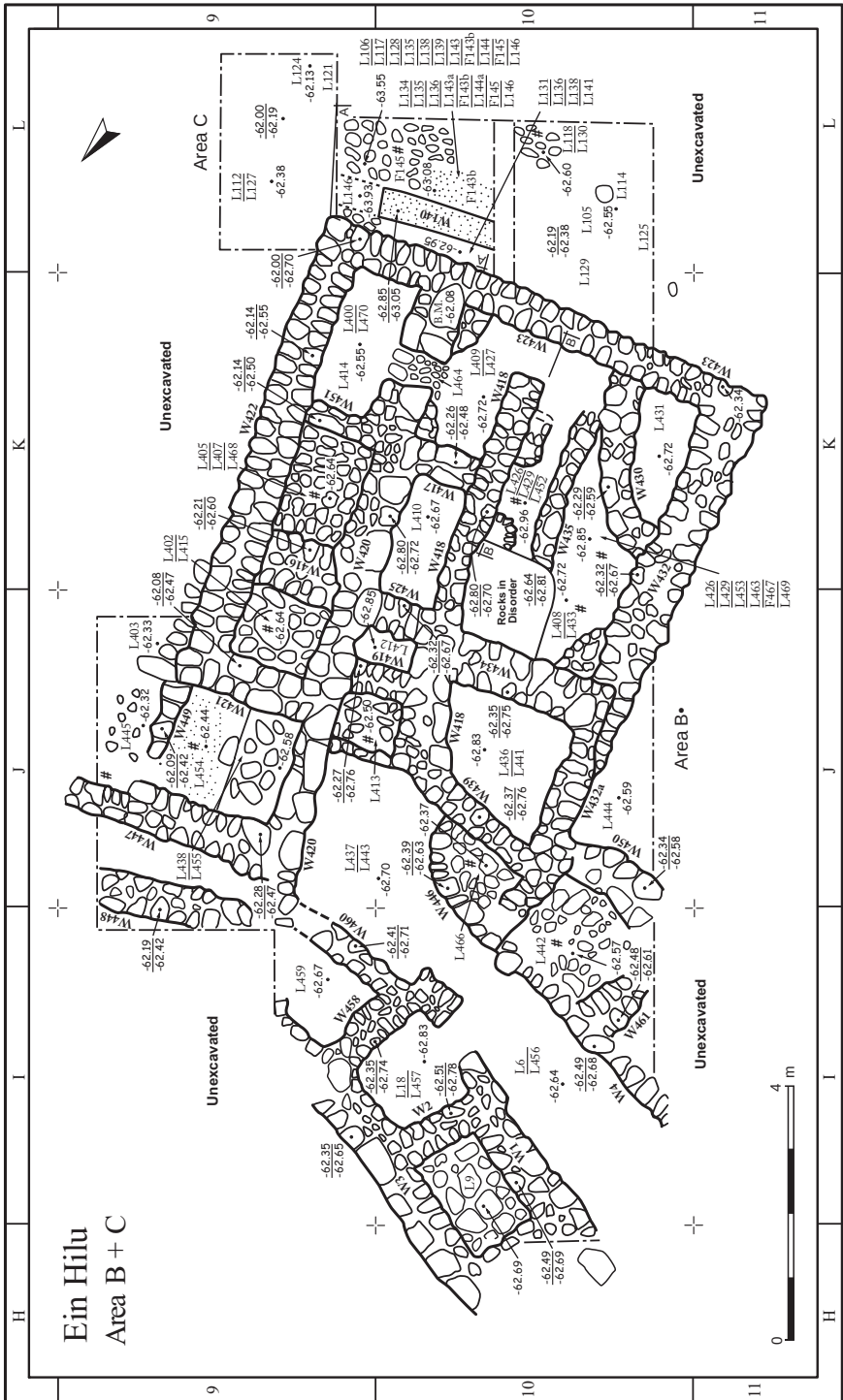
469. General plan of the Chalcolithic Period village at 'Ain el-Hilu (B). Excavation was carried out in the marked squares. The lines of walls denote complexes or courtyards. 2006.



470. View of the Chalcolithic Period site at 'Ain el-Hilu (B), looking north. 1988.



471. Stone foundations of one of the structures at 'Ain el-Hilu (B). An elongated jar with two hole handles was found leaning against a wall. 1988.



472. Plan of areas B-C, excavations at 'Ain el-Hilu (B), 2006.

Site 231: 20 – 19/02/1

el-Beyaz

Israel grid: 2003 1926
 UTM grid: 7382 5794
 Elevation: 80 m b.s.l., 70 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: prehistoric site
 Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)
 Topography: ridge and slope
 Rock type: Tiberias formation
 Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest
 soil; quality: 4

Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: Jordan River
 (no. 112), 2 km distant
 Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Ham-
 meh (B10), 1 km distant
 Visibility: 7
 Apr. 4, 1986; Dec. 16, 1988; 68 flint
 items

* * *

A site of stone circles on the high, eastern slope of the ridge of el-Beyaz, 1.5 km northwest of the settlement Brosh.

The four stone circles are described as follows (from south to north):

1. A small circle, 7 m in diameter, well built of large stones.

2. The central circle, 20 m in diameter and irregular in shape, built of large stones, some in upright position; A small structure adjoins it on its east.

3. A large circle, about 32 m in diameter, adjoining no. 2 on the

south. It is not well preserved, with large sections missing. Its construction is similar to no. 2.

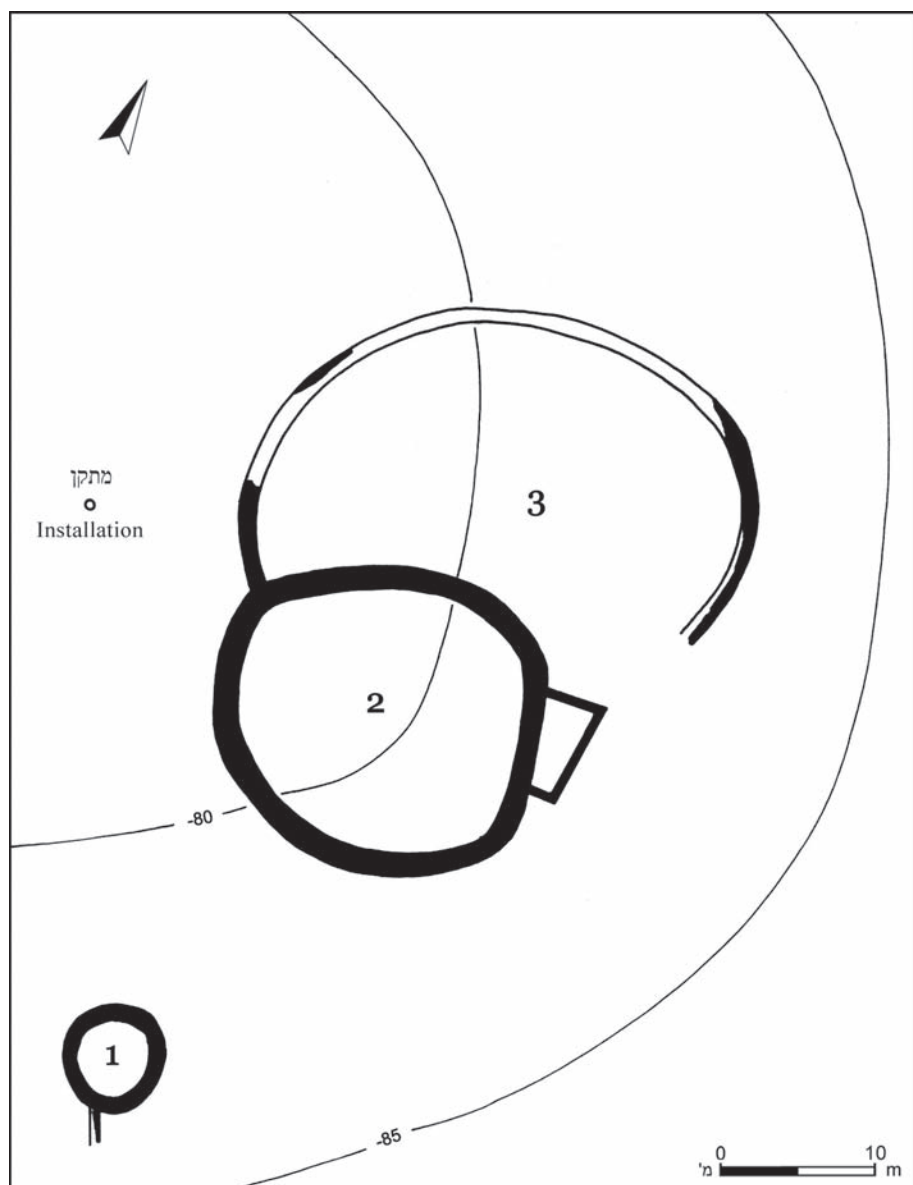
4. A small circle, 4 m in diameter, on the northern part of the site (not on the plan).

There is a basin hewn in rock in the western side.

Similar circle sites were also found in Mrah Ra'iyān (site no. 37 here), Zahret el-Meidan (B) (site no. 256 here) and Ras en-Naqb Baqar (site no. 261 here).

Flint finds only: see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



473. The site of stone circles of el-Beyaz. Their meaning and function are unknown.

Site 232: 19 – 19/71/1

Tabqet el-Hilweh

Israel grid: 1975 1915

UTM grid: 7356 5784

Elevation: 40 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin

Area: 27 dunams (6.75 acres)

Topography: slope and valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest
soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 3

Cultivation: none

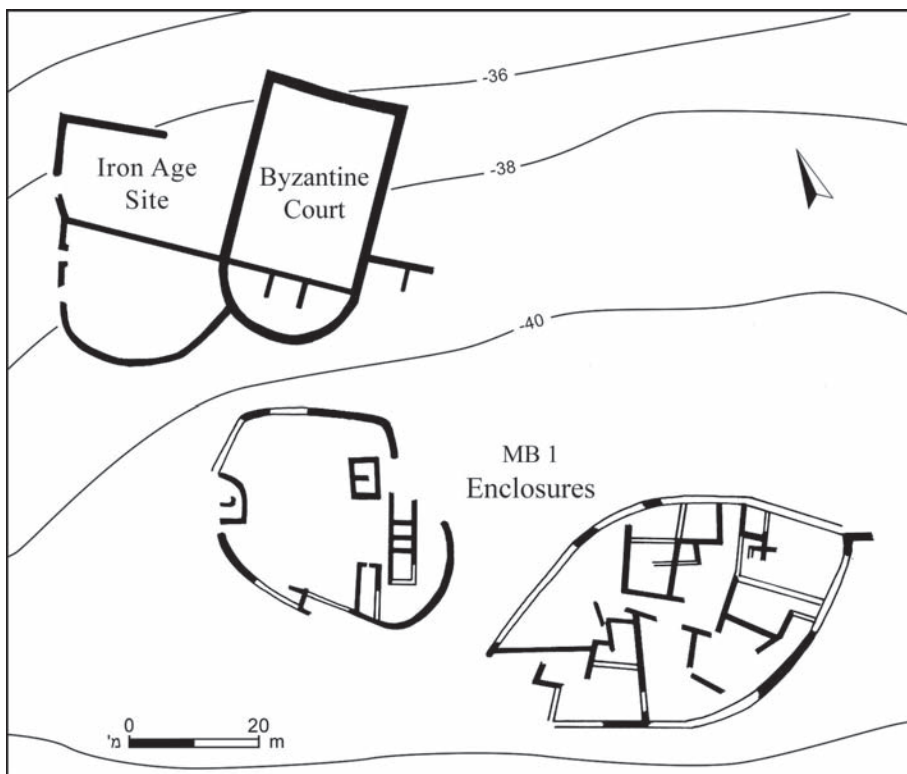
Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun
Hilu, no. 88), 1 km distantNearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-
Hilu (C23), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 3

Jan. 2, 1987; Feb. 5, 1988; 61 shards
and 42 flint items

* * *

A large site on a moderate slope de-
scending northward into Tabqet el-Hilweh Valley, about 6 km south-
southwest of Meholah. Part of the

474. Plan of the site of Tabqet el-Hilweh. The enclosures in the center and at right were built in Middle Bronze Age I; the enclosures in the upper part are of a later date.

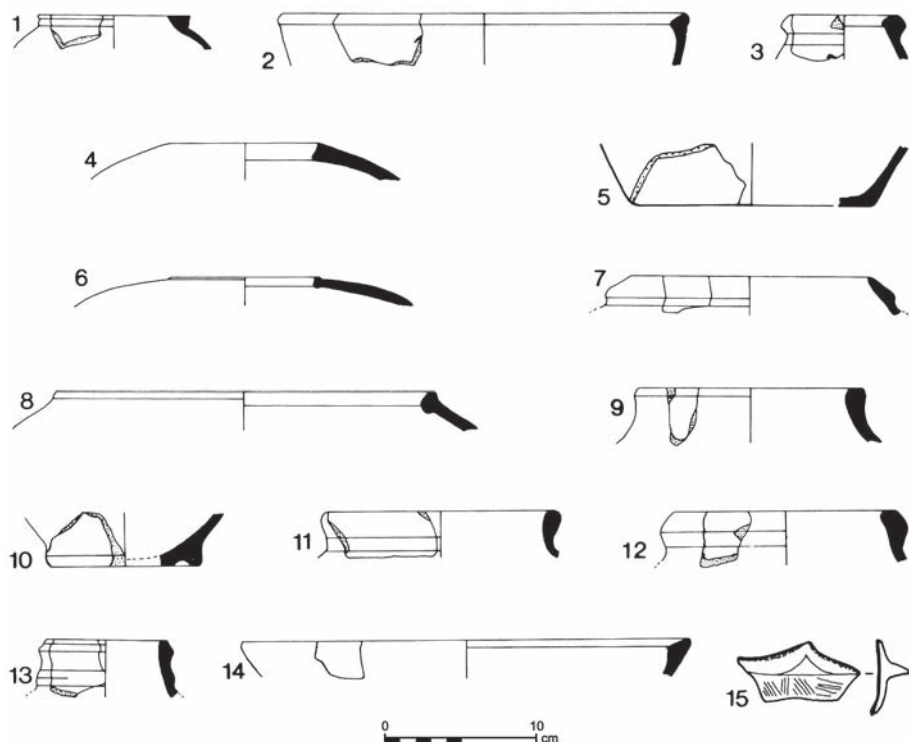
ancient site is today in the area of the settlement Maskiyot.

The place is situated in a topographical "bowl" surrounded by hills. In the southern and the highest part, are three units of courtyard settlements surrounded by enclosure wall. The easternmost is oval in shape, with two sharp tips. Inside are several dwelling units *in situ*. The average diameter of this courtyards is 40 m, with walls built of large stones. Its neighbor from the west is 30 m in diameter, with house remains inside. In the dwell-

ing units square or irregular rooms were found; apparently this part of the site dates back to Middle Bronze Age I.

On top of the above settlement, after a long cessation of settlement, a smaller site was built during and after Iron Age II. This consists of a large, square courtyard in a shape of an apsis, 40x40 m in size, and it was built on the northeastern part of the ancient settlement. To the west of the site there is a cave.

Pottery: MBA I – 50%; MBA IIB – 5%; IrA II – 20%; Byz – 15%;



475. Pottery from the site of Tabqet el-Hilweh: 1. Jug, br, LR; 2, 14. Bowls, yel, MBA I; 3. Jug, br, IrA II; 4-6, 8. HM jars, yel gr, MBA I; 7. CP, dk br, IrA I-II; 9. Jar, gr, MBA I; 10-13. Jars, br, IrA II; 15. Ledge handle, yel, MBA I.

EM – 5%; MA – 5%.

Flint find: MBA I (the majority); see appendix.

This site is one of the largest of the Middle Bronze Age I in the Manasseh fringes, and resembles several sites of the Negev highlands. On its ruins an Iron Age II

farm was built; possibly during the Byzantine Period it was dismantled and a small village was built on top of it. The wide expanses of pasture land and the small valley nearby provided the economic basis of the settlement.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 233: 20 – 19/11/1

Khirbet Wahraneh

Israel grid: 2013 1913

UTM grid: 7395 5783

Elevation: 190 m b.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure and small site (farm?)

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: narrow ridge

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River (no. 112), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Ham-meh (B10), passes by site

Visibility: 4

Mar. 6, 1988; 19 shards

* * *

A small site at the edge of a rocky ridge with a view of the Jordan Valley, located next to and west of the Beth-Shean-Jericho road and 0.5 km to the south of Brosh.

There are the remains of a structure, 3.5x5 m in size, built of hewn stones. Destruction has rendered

the building plan unclear. Nearby on the slope there are terraces and various walls. The site was possibly a farm or an isolated structure during the Roman Period.

Pottery: LR – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.

Site 234: 19 – 19/70/1

Re'us et-Tabaq

Israel grid: 1972 1906

UTM grid: 7351 5773

Elevation: 28 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosures and courtyard

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: saddle on plateau

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina; qual-

ity: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 1 km distant

Visibility: 5

Feb. 12, 1988; 33 shards and 12 flint items

* * *

A site on a high ridge, overlooking the Jordan Valley, to Tabqet el-Hilweh and Wadi Fau. Steep slopes descend from the ridge westward, to the Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu

Road.

In the center is a courtyard, 15x25 m in size, with a surrounding wall 1.2 m wide, built of two rows of large stones. In the northwestern



476. Re'us et-Tabaq, viewed to the east. Note the remains of the Byzantine Period courtyard.